

CITY: Pg 3

Gaushalas get ₹20.26 crore boost

NATION: Pg 5

PM: Infiltration not just poll issue but about safeguarding national security

FILM: Pg 14

Rahul Arunoday Banerjee's death shocks Tollywood



Trump threatens to destroy Iran's energy facilities if deal not reached 'shortly'

IRAN REJECTS PAKISTAN'S OFFER TO HOST US-IRAN NEGOTIATIONS, DISTANCES FROM INITIATIVE

ASSOCIATED PRESS

DUBAI: US President Donald Trump on Monday threatened widespread destruction of Iran's energy resources and other vital infrastructure, including desalination plants, if a deal to end the war is not reached "shortly."

Tehran, meanwhile, struck a key water and electrical plant in Kuwait, and an oil refinery in Israel came under attack. Israel and the US launched a new wave of strikes on Iran, as the war raged with no end in sight.

Trump's new threat in a social media post and earlier comments in an interview with the Financial Times that suggested American troops could seize Iran's Kharg Island oil export hub highlighted a frequent tactic. He has repeatedly claimed to be making diplomatic progress — though Tehran denies negotiating directly



People inspect the site of an Israeli airstrike that struck an apartment building in Dahiyeh, Beirut's southern suburbs, Lebanon, on Monday

— while ramping up his threats and sending thousands more US troops to the Middle East. After Pakistan claimed it was ready to host direct talks between

the US and Iran to end their ongoing war, Iran has issued a clear denial of any involvement in such Pakistani-led efforts. The Consulate General

of Iran in Mumbai stated on Monday that there have been no direct talks with the US, only excessive and unreasonable demands passed through

intermediaries. The consulate said Pakistan's forums are its own affair and that Iran did not participate in them.

KEY POINTS

- » Tehran denies direct US talks, calls Washington's demands excessive and unrealistic
- » US and Israel launch fresh strikes on Iranian targets amid escalating conflict
- » Iran hits Kuwait power and desalination plant; one worker killed, ten soldiers injured
- » Missile attacks and interceptions reported across Saudi Arabia, UAE, and Gulf region
- » Israeli refinery targeted; sirens sound near key nuclear research facility

ISRAEL STRIKES TEHRAN INFRASTRUCTURE; PETROCHEMICAL PLANT IN TABRIZ DAMAGED

SPAIN CLOSES AIRSPACE FOR US PLANES INVOLVED IN IRAN WAR

MADRID: Spain has closed its airspace to US planes involved in the Iran war, the defence minister said Monday, marking another step in the government's opposition to US and Israeli involvement in the conflict in the Middle East.

The country had already said the US couldn't use jointly operated military bases in the Iran conflict, which Spain's Prime Minister Pedro Sánchez has described as illegal, reckless and unjust.

Continued on P4

Rupee posts biggest annual decline in 14 years, tumbles 9.88% in FY26

Rupee breaches 95-per-dollar level in intra-day trade

MPOST BUREAU

MUMBAI: The rupee has recorded its steepest annual fall in over a decade, declining 9.88 per cent against the US dollar in FY26, as global shocks, rising crude oil prices and sustained capital outflows combined to keep the currency under pressure. The depreciation marks the sharpest drop in 14 years, approaching levels last seen in FY12 when the rupee had weakened 12.4 per cent amid a widening current account deficit of 4.2 per cent.

The slide in FY26 has been shaped largely by external factors, including geopolitical tensions, elevated energy prices and tightening global liquidity, alongside a strengthening US dollar. Market participants said the pressure intensified after the United States imposed tariffs on India, triggering a surge in dollar demand and prompting sustained foreign capital outflows from domestic equity and debt markets.

The situation worsened following the escalation of conflict in West Asia, which entered its 31st day and pushed crude oil prices higher, adding to volatility in currency markets. Brent crude was trading at USD 114.97 per barrel, up 2.60 per cent, while safe-haven demand kept the dollar index firm above the 100 mark, limiting any meaningful recovery in the rupee.

On Monday, the rupee breached the psychological 95-per-dollar level in intra-day trade, hitting a record low of 95.22 before recovering partially. It eventually settled at 94.70, gaining 15 paise from its previous close of 94.85. During the session, the currency witnessed sharp swings of 165 paise, reflecting heightened volatility in global markets.

The trading day began



TAKEAWAYS

- » FY12 saw a steeper 12.4% fall amid 4.2% current account deficit
- » Depreciation driven by oil prices, capital outflows, and strong dollar
- » US tariffs on India triggered early surge in dollar demand
- » West Asia conflict intensified pressure via rising crude prices
- » Brent crude reached USD 114.97 per barrel, up 2.60%
- » Dollar index stayed firm above 100, limiting rupee recovery

on a stronger note, with the rupee opening at 93.62 and briefly rising to 93.57 after the Reserve Bank of India introduced fresh measures to curb speculation. However, gains were quickly erased due to strong dollar demand from oil companies and persistent external pressures.

The central bank has intervened heavily to stabilise the currency, selling USD 55.073 billion in the spot market up to January in FY26. It has also tightened regulatory norms by capping banks' net open positions in the onshore currency market at USD 100 million, effective April 10. The move is aimed at limiting large speculative bets against the rupee and reducing excessive volatility.

Despite these efforts, the rupee has repeatedly tested record lows during the fiscal year. On Friday, it had already plunged 89 paise to close at an all-time low of

Continued on P4

Rain, snow lash North as western disturbance brings relief

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Rain and snowfall persisted across parts of north India on Monday, with several regions experiencing relief from rising temperatures under the influence of a fresh western disturbance.

In Delhi, light showers arrived in the evening after a warm and humid day when temperatures hovered around 35 degrees Celsius. Rainfall between 2:30 pm and 5:30 pm was recorded at multiple stations, with Safdarjung logging 0.5 mm, Palam 0.2 mm, Lodi Road 0.7 mm, Ridge 0.2 mm, Ayanagar 0.6 mm, Pusa 0.5 mm and Janakpuri 0.5 mm. Mayur Vihar reported the highest rainfall at 1.0 mm.

Neighbouring states also saw weather changes. Strong winds swept parts of Rajasthan, including Jaipur, accompanied by light rain in several areas. In Uttar Pradesh, Aligarh and Agra recorded light showers, while Lucknow registered a maximum temperature of 37.4 degrees Celsius and a minimum of 22.0 degrees Celsius. Banda remained the hottest in the state at 41.4 degrees Celsius, followed by Prayagraj at 40.5 degrees Celsius.

Meteorological experts linked the conditions to a western disturbance and an associated cyclonic circulation over northwest Rajasthan, which triggered rainfall across Delhi, Haryana, Rajasthan and western Uttar Pradesh. Further north, Jammu and Kashmir witnessed

Continued on P4

PM Modi silent on Sabarimala issue, doesn't care about religion

Rahul Gandhi

In today's paper

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GOVT ASSURES

'ATF supplies available for 60 days without interruption'

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: India has sufficient stocks of Aviation Turbine Fuel to meet demand for the next two months, Civil Aviation Minister K. Jaganmohan Reddy told the Rajya Sabha on Monday, amid concerns triggered by the ongoing West Asia conflict.

Responding to a supplementary question on fuel availability, the minister said there would be no disruption in supply. "We have an adequate supply of ATF in our country right now," he said, adding that current reserves can sustain operations for the next 60 days without interruption. He also explained that domestic production remains stable, with roughly half of the output catering to internal consumption and the remainder being exported.

Naidu noted that the government does not anticipate any issues in ATF production despite global uncertainties linked to the conflict. His remarks come as several countries assess fuel security in light of geopolitical tensions in oil-producing regions.

On aviation safety, the minister said oversight measures have been strengthened. "We have increased the number of audits on the airlines. We are doing the audits multiple times. Safety is the top-most priority for the ministry," he stated, indicating closer monitoring of airline operations. Addressing questions about emergency landings, Naidu said decisions are guided primarily by safety considerations. He explained that factors such as aircraft type, weather conditions, and regulatory compliance determine how and where landings are carried out.

Naidu noted that the government does not anticipate any issues in ATF production despite global uncertainties linked to the conflict

Continued on P4

Shah shreds Cong, says Modi govt ended Naxal violence

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Monday said Naxalism is in its "last breath" and has nearly been wiped out from Chhattisgarh's Bastar, the hotbed of Maoist violence.

Detailing the government's push in the Lok Sabha, Amit Shah said Bastar is now on the "path of development", while crediting security forces, state police and local tribal communities for the turnaround. His remarks came ahead of the March 31 deadline set by the Centre to eradicate Left Wing extremism.

He accused the Congress of doing "nothing" during its rule to end the long spell of Naxal violence, despite acknowledging the gravity of the problem, and declared that Maoists are almost eradicated now from their den Bastar in Chhattisgarh. Replying to the debate in the Lok Sabha on 'Efforts to free the country from left-wing extremism (LWE)', Shah said that 12 states had turned into the Red Corridor with no rule of law, 12 crore people lived in poverty for years and 20,000 people, including 5,000 security personnel, were killed due to the Naxal violence.

"In the end, who is responsible for this. I want to ask, in 75 years, you ruled for 60 years, why have the tribals still been deprived of development? The development of tribals is now being done by Prime Minister Narendra Modi," he said.

The Home Minister alleged that for 60 years, the Congress "did not give the tribals houses, didn't give them water, didn't build schools, didn't extend bank facilities".

"So first look a little into your own reign and see who is at fault," he



IN THE END, WHO IS RESPONSIBLE FOR THIS. I WANT TO ASK, IN 75 YEARS, YOU RULED FOR 60 YEARS, WHY HAVE THE TRIBALS STILL BEEN DEPRIVED OF DEVELOPMENT? THE DEVELOPMENT OF TRIBALS IS NOW BEING DONE BY PRIME MINISTER NARENDRA MODI

said in response to some opposition members blaming the Modi government for the violence.

Shah said the then prime minister Manmohan Singh had acknowledged that Naxalism was a bigger challenge than the Kashmir and North-East problems before the nation, but the "Congress did nothing about it".

Last year, Shah had announced that the LWE would end in the country by March 31, 2026, and a major operation had been organised against the Naxals.

Continued on P4

CITIZENS CAN SUBMIT DETAILS ONLINE BEFORE ENUMERATOR VISITS

Census 2027 will be India's first fully digital population count

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The central government has announced that Census 2027 will be conducted in a fully digital format for the first time, marking a major shift in how the country collects population data. People can file details online ahead of a visit from a census worker. This shift opens a new path — submit early and avoid repeat checks. The system leans on access, clarity, and timing. Each household gets a chance to respond beforehand, easing the process when someone comes knocking.

A fresh headcount looms for India — its sixteenth go-around, eighth after freedom — shaped by laws from '48 and rules set in 1990. Not since 2011 has the country paused to count every soul. Then again, come 2027,



another round begins, confirmed flat-out on June 16, 2025.

One piece at a time, the count begins with housing records. Starting in April 2026, teams will log home setups across most

regions until September. Yet in places such as Goa, Karnataka, and Mizoram, fieldwork wraps up by mid-May. Earlier, between April 1st and 15th, families may type in their home facts on a

site — no need to wait. That early step gives them a special code. Later, when workers knock, sharing it speeds things along. Island zones like Lakshadweep follow this quicker timeline too. Even

Delhi's selected spots move fast. Home features, what's inside, who lives there — all noted. Not every state runs the same dates, though. Some finish sooner because of local plans.

Continued on P4

CLOSER LOOK

- » Early submission reduces repeat checks and speeds verification
- » India's 16th census, 8th after Independence
- » Last census conducted in 2011; next confirmed June 16, 2025
- » Housing listing phase runs April–September 2026
- » Some states (Goa, Karnataka, Mizoram) finish housing count by mid-May
- » Online self-enumeration window opens April 1–15, 2026
- » Early submissions generate a unique code for quick verification
- » Population Enumeration scheduled mainly for February 2027

REFERENCE DATES: OCT 1, 2026 (SNOW REGIONS); MARCH 1, 2027 (ELSEWHERE)

ACCUSED ARRESTED; TODDLER WAS PRESENT AT THE HOUSE

Woman dies after being struck with LPG cylinder by husband

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 32-year-old woman was allegedly killed after her husband attacked her with a small LPG cylinder during a domestic dispute in southeast Delhi's Pul Prahladpur area, police said on Monday.

The victim has been identified as Poonam, while the accused, Suresh Kumar, has been arrested following the incident that took place at their residence in DDA Janta Flats, they said.

According to the police, the couple got married in 2020 and had recently shifted to Delhi from Rajasthan's Churu district about a month ago.

"The incident came to light after neighbours alerted authorities upon hearing screams from the house. A police team rushed to the spot and found Poonam lying critically injured. She was immediately shifted to a nearby hospital,



Probe suggests couple argued over financial support for husband's brother

where doctors declared her brought dead," Deputy Commissioner of Police (Southeast) Hemant Tiwari said.

Initial investigation suggests that the couple had an argument over financial support for the husband's brother, which escalated into a violent altercation.

During the fight, Kumar picked up a small LPG cylinder

and struck his wife multiple times, resulting in fatal injuries, police said.

The couple has two daughters -- a four-year-old who currently lives with grandparents in Churu, and another aged around one-and-a-half years who was present at the house at the time of the incident, the officer said.

Neighbours of the fam-

HIGHLIGHTS

» The incident came to light after neighbours alerted authorities upon hearing screams from the house: Police

» Police team rushed to the spot and found Poonam lying critically injured. She was shifted to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared her brought dead

the time she stepped out, a crowd had gathered outside the house, and there was blood near the entrance. The couple's toddler was crying.

Police have taken the accused into custody and registered a case of murder. The crime scene has been secured, and forensic teams have inspected the spot.

Another neighbour, who had seen the couple earlier in the day, said the family appeared reserved but normal.

"They looked like a normal family. She was often seen carrying the younger child in the corridor. They weren't very talkative. The couple has a small child... who will take care of the baby now?" she said.

Additionally, investigators are also examining the couple's background and questioning neighbours and relatives to establish the sequence of events leading up to the murder. The body has been sent for postmortem.

Son & daughter-in-law murder elderly woman

FARIDABAD: A 65-year-old woman was murdered allegedly by her own son and daughter-in-law, reportedly to grab the land compensation amount in Sector 67 area here, police said on Monday.

After the investigation, the police registered a murder case at Sadar Ballabgarh police station, arresting the accused daughter-in-law, Poonam, who confessed to beating and strangling his mother-in-law to grab the compensation money, they said. The deceased woman's son, Lalit, also assisted his wife in the crime, which occurred between 1 and 3 pm on March 16 in the Machghar village in Faridabad's Sector 67, police said, adding that police are conducting raids to nab the absconding son.

According to the police, the deceased woman, Omwati, had two sons, and both are married. She had been living in the house for some time with her elder son Lalit and daughter-in-law Poonam.

Her younger son Amit and his wife Mamta live in a rented house in Ballabgarh's Bhikam Colony, police said.

It was around 4 pm on March 16 when Mamta



received a phone call informing her that her mother-in-law had died. She immediately informed the police, claiming that her mother-in-law had told her a few days earlier that Lalit and Poonam might kill her to grab the compensation money, they added.

A police team, along with a forensic team, reached the scene and collected evidence. The deceased's bangles were broken and embedded in the hands. There were injury marks on her neck and face, they said.

The body was handed over to the family after the post-mortem, police said. Police arrested Poonam, who confessed to killing her mother-in-law over a property dispute. She and Lalit allegedly assaulted and strangled her; raids are underway to arrest him. **MP05T**

Nigerian national dies after being apprehended by police

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A Nigerian national died under suspicious circumstances after being apprehended by Delhi Police during a routine patrol under "Operation Kavach" in west Delhi's Rajouri Garden area on Sunday evening.

According to police, Special Staff personnel were patrolling busy roads and public areas as part of the ongoing security drive when they noticed a man riding a black TVS Scooty in the wrong direction towards Rajouri Garden Metro Station, raising suspicion.

'When officers tried to stop him, the rider rammed his scooter into a police motorcycle, fell, fled on foot, and was apprehended'

When officers attempted to stop him, the rider allegedly rammed his scooter into a police motorcycle. He fell, abandoned the vehicle and tried to flee on foot, but was apprehended after a brief chase.

Officials said he was taken to the Special Staff office near Tagore Garden for questioning. During the process, the suspect reportedly complained of uneasiness and did not cooperate, prompting police to shift him to Guru Gobind Singh Hospital in Khyala, where doctors declared him brought dead.

The deceased was identified as Christian Eze Promise, a Nigerian national. His body has been preserved at the AIIMS mortuary for further procedures.

Authorities said intimation has been sent to the National Human Rights Commission, Ministry of External Affairs and the Nigerian High Commission. Further legal proceedings are underway.

International Film Festival opens

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The inaugural edition of the International Film Festival Delhi 2026 witnessed a grand celebration of cinema and culture at the 'Night of Honors' held at Bharat Mandapam on Monday. The event was attended by Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, and Tourism Minister Kapil Mishra, along with prominent figures from the film industry.

Addressing the gathering, the Lieutenant Governor highlighted the broader vision of the festival, stating, "This is not merely an event, but the foundation of a movement that will shape Delhi's cultural future." He added that cinema reflects "courage, perspective, and truth," and serves as a bridge



connecting Indian stories with global audiences.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta termed the festival a significant milestone for the capital. "IFFD is a significant step towards establishing Delhi as a global cultural and cinematic hub," she said, noting that the platform would create opportunities for emerging artists and strengthen the creative economy.

Tourism Minister Kapil Mishra emphasised the role of meaningful cinema, urging filmmakers to balance commercial success with social impact. "Along with making films that earn Rs.100 crore, continue to make films that awaken 100 crore people," he said.

The event saw participation from noted personalities including Rakeysh Omprakash Mehra, Anupam Kher, Bhumi Pednekar, and Ramesh Sippy, who was honoured for 50 years of the iconic film Sholay.

IFFD 2026 recorded participation from over 100 countries, with more than 2,100 entries and 30,000 registrations. Over 125 films from 47 countries were screened, reinforcing Delhi's emergence as a global hub for cinema and cultural exchange.

First phase of Census to begin in city on Apr 16

NEW DELHI: The first phase of Census 2027, House Listing Operations, will begin in Delhi on April 16 during which information pertaining to all structures, houses, and households will be collected, Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India Mrityunjay Kumar Narayan said Monday.

The exercise will run in two 30-day windows-- from April 16 to May 15 for areas under NDMC and Delhi Cantonment, and for areas under MCD from May 16 to June 15 as outlined in the schedule, he said at a press conference.

The self-enumeration for the NDMC and Delhi Cantonment areas will begin on April 1, and for the MCD, from May 1 to May 15.

The citizens will have the option of self-enumeration, where they visit the self-enu-



Census Commissioner Mrityunjay Kumar Narayan

meration website, register, and provide all the information, after which a 16-digit code will be generated, Narayan said.

"This code shall be shared with the enumerator when he visits the household, where he would verify the information shared by an individual digitally in self-enumeration. The citizens can make any necessary corrections at this stage. Once verified, the information

shall be submitted," he said.

The Census 2027 is being conducted in two phases -- the first stage is known as house listing and housing census, and the second stage is the population census. In a first, the exercise will be completely digital, with enumerators using a special mobile application created for the purpose on their phones to collect the information.

The citizens will be posed with 33 questions during the exercise regarding basic facilities in their houses, information about the head of the household, such as the name and sex, and the ownership status. According to the gazette notification issued on January 22, the enumerators would also ask about the number of dwelling rooms exclusively in possession of the household and the number of married

couple(s) living there, the main source of drinking water, main source of lighting, access to and type of latrine, wastewater outlet, availability of bathing facility, availability of kitchen and LPG and PNG connection and the main fuel used for cooking.

The enumerators will also collect information about radio and transistor, television set, access to internet, gadgets like laptops, computers, telephones, mobile phones, and smartphones, type of vehicle, the main cereal consumed in the household, and mobile numbers for census-related communication, it had said.

An officer who intimatedly puts "any offensive or improper question" during the Census 2027 will face a punishment with imprisonment which may extend to three years upon conviction. **PTI**

'Judges, police must set aside bias in rape cases'

NEW DELHI: Former Chief Justice of the Jammu and Kashmir High Court Gita Mittal highlighted systemic and social challenges faced by rape survivors, stating that access to courts does not always translate into access to justice. Speaking at a film screening and panel discussion in Delhi, she noted that even police and judges may carry "social baggage," affecting their handling of such cases.

Recalling a case involving an eight-year-old victim, she said the crime was vaguely recorded due to stigma, reflecting discomfort within the legal system. "Access to justice actually is not synonymous with access to courts," she said, stressing the need to empower survivors to testify confidently.



Mittal also pointed out that lack of evidence can lead to acquittals even in genuine cases, calling it a "grave injustice." She urged judges and investigators to remain unbiased and more vigilant during trials. Senior advocate Vrinda Grover criticised selective outrage, warned against vigilantism, and stressed addressing patriarchy and inequality to effectively curb sexual violence. **MP05T**

HC reiterates no-vending rule at Nehru Place, orders removal

NEW DELHI: The Delhi High Court has reiterated that Nehru Place District Commercial Complex is a "no-vending" and "no-hawking" zone, directing authorities to immediately remove all unauthorised vendors operating in the area.

A Division Bench comprising Justice Prathiba M Singh and Justice Madhu Jain passed the order on March 24 while dismissing a plea filed by two vendors seeking protection from eviction. The petitioners had sought permission to continue vending near Mansarovar Building, claiming long-standing presence in the area.

Rejecting their plea, the Court said, "The Petitioners do not have any rights to be vending in the Nehru Place area..."



the relief sought by the Petitioners... cannot be acceded to." It also imposed a cost of Rs.10,000 on them.

The Court noted that the petitioners had repeatedly approached courts with similar claims despite earlier dismissals by the High Court and the Supreme Court of India declining to intervene. It observed that their names

were not included in official lists of recognised vendors prepared under previous judicial directions.

Highlighting safety concerns, the Bench referred to earlier proceedings, including a 2021 suo motu case following a fire incident, where congestion caused by hawkers was flagged. The Court said such vending activities pose "severe safety and security concerns" in the commercial hub.

Taking note that the petitioners were still operating in the area, the Court expressed concern and directed the Municipal Corporation of Delhi to take immediate action to ensure compliance. The matter has been listed for further compliance on May 21. **MP05T**

Man drowns after slipping into drain

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 33-year-old daily wage worker drowned after slipping into a drain while cleaning it in east Delhi's Dilshad Garden on Monday, officials said. Delhi Fire Services received a call around 2 pm and launched a rescue operation with local responders. The man, identified as Rahul, fell into the nala while removing silt.

He was pulled out after sustained efforts and rushed to GTB Hospital, where he was declared dead. Police said Rahul, a resident of Sundar Nagari, had been deployed with another worker. An FIR under BNS Section 106(1) has been registered and further investigation is underway.

PUBLIC NOTICE				
ICICI Bank				
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005				
The following borrower(s) has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. The Loan(s) has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset(s) (NPA). A Notice was issued to them under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, at their last known addresses. However, it has not been served and are therefore being notified by way of this Public Notice.				
Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number) & Address	Description of Secured Asset to be enforced	Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Prem Singh Varun- Deceased (Through His Legal Heir)/ Anis Alvi/ LBNHPU0004243580/ 10A Delhi Road Apna Ghar Colony Hapur, Hapur, UP- 245101	Part of Plot No. 10 A, Khasra No. 744 Min Situated At Village Chamri (Mohalla Apna Ghar Colony) Hapur Pargana Tehsil Panchsheel Nagar And District Hapur Uttar Pradesh- 245101	12-03-2026 Rs. 21,96,008.33/-	30-Apr-2019
2.	Nem Singh/ Sunita./ TBAL00006423561/ TBAL00006767696/ 87/3 Khair Bypass Alapur Garhia Deevnagar Colony, Khair Road Uttar Pradesh Aligarh- 202001	Property At Old Khasra No. 87 & Part of New Khasra No. 87/3, Mouza Alapur Garhiya (Dev Nagar Colony) Pargana And Tehsil Kail District Aligarh Uttar Pradesh- 202001	11-03-2026/ Rs. 10,48,355/- Rs. 2,76,120/-	19-Dec-2025
3.	Chander Shekhar/ Seema Kumari/ LBDEL0000639393/ E3231, Sector 18 Paradise Apartment Rohini Delhi- 110089	Residential Flat/ Dwelling Unit No.1702, 16th Floor, Tower/ Block- 08, "Unitach Horizon" Situated At Plot No. 6, Alstonia Estate, Sector-PI-02, Greater Noida, District Gautam Budh Nagar Uttar Pradesh- 201307	06-03-2026 Rs. 30,51,009/-	06-Dec-2025
4.	Tanmay Bagga/ Jaimala./ LBNOD00005688457/ H No. E 25 3rd Floor GK 2 Enclave Delhi- 110048	Flat No. LE/E-1907, 19th Floor (Without Roof Rights) Tower E, Type-III, With One Covered Car Parking, Luxuria Estate, Situated At Plot No. GH-1, Sector-06, Aditya World City, NH-24, Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh 201001	06-03-2026 Rs. 25,56,519/-	14-Dec-2025
5.	Malika Tewari/ Anjali Tiwari/ LBNOD00006632243/ H.No. 82 A Lotus Shrishti Apartment, Grossing Republic, Uttar Pradesh Ghaziabad- 201016	Apartment No. 820, 8th Floor, Tower- 9, "Dream Homes", Greenwood Enclave, Situated At Plot No. GH-6A, Sector-5, Wave City, Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh- 201001 (Along With Car Parking Under Bearing No. S-233M)	06-03-2026 Rs. 16,93,866/-	02-Dec-2025
6.	Heena Kapoor/ Sushama Kapoor/ LBNOD00005163918/ B 226 Shramik Kunj Sector 110 Uttar Pradesh Noida- 201301	Apartment No. KM00360205, 2nd Floor, Tower No. KM-36, Kosmos, With One Covered Car Parking, Jaypee Greens Wish Town, Sector 134, Noida Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh- 201304	06-03-2026 Rs. 11,32,700.98/-	04-Dec-2025
7.	Narendra Sharma/ TBNOD00006512244/ F-1108, 11th Floor Avj Heights Sector Zita 1 Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh Greater Noida- 201306	Studia Aptt No.- SA 406 On The 4th Floor, Kaveri City Centre, C-06 Delta One Greater Noida Gautam Budh Nagar Uttar Pradesh- 201310	09-03-2026 Rs. 24,21,086.06/-	08-Jun-2025
8.	Alok Kumar/ Nancy Yadev/ LBDEL00003295059/ LBNOD00002852743/ Flat No. 1407 Orchid Tower, Paramount Symphony, Crossing Republic Ghaziabad- 201016	Flat No. T2- 1904, 19th Floor, Nirala Estate, Situated At GH- 04, Techzone- IV, Uttar Pradesh, Greater Noida West- 201307	26-02-2026 Rs. 3,65,044/- Rs. 18,13,528/-	03-Oct-2025
9.	Siddiqui Masroor Azar/ Nikhar Khan/ LBGUR00002326786/ Shivalki A 219 Chattarpur Enclave Phase-I Delhi Delhi- 110074	Flat No. 1305, 13th Floor, Gayatri Aura, Block F, Situated At Plot No. GH-11, Sec-1, Greater Noida West- 201307	06-03-2026 Rs. 21,61,780/-	04-Dec-2025
10.	Sudhir Kumar Chauhan/ Pinky Chauhan/ LBDEL00001409345/ Flat No. F1 Plot No. B-1/17 Dlf Extn-II Ghaziabad- 201005	Mig Flat No. F-1, First Floor, (Without Roof Rights) Situated At Dlf Dilshad Extn. No. II, Village Brahmputr Alias Bhupura Pargana Loni Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh- 201001	06-03-2026 Rs. 9,31,117.95/-	08-Nov-2022
11.	Himanshu Jindal/ Suman Jindal/ LBDEL00005225136/ V2-603 Kingsbury Apartment Tdi City Sector 61 Haryana Sonapat- 131021	Property 1: Part of Freehold Built Up Property Bearing No. 282, Entire Second Floor Without Roof/ Terrace Rights, Pocket 4, Sector 22, Situated At Rohini Residential Scheme Rohini, Delhi- 110086 And Property 2: Part of Freehold Built Up Property Bearing No. 283, Entire Second Floor Without Roof/ Terrace Rights, Pocket 4, Sector 22, Situated At Rohini Residential Scheme Rohini, Delhi- 110086	06-03-2026 Rs. 34,25,340/-	28-Dec-2025

These steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower/s and/or guarantor/s (as applicable) is/are advised to make the outstanding payment within 60 days from the date of publishing this Notice. Else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Date: March 31, 2026
Place: Delhi/ Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

GOVT AIMS TO IMPROVE STRAY CATTLE WELFARE

Gaushalas get ₹20.26 crore boost as Delhi outlines expansion, upgrades

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a significant move to strengthen animal welfare in the national capital, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday announced a financial package of Rs.20.26 crore for gaushalas and outlined plans to develop modern infrastructure for the care of stray cattle. The announcement was made at an event held at the Chief Minister's Jan Seva Sadan, where lease extension certificates were also distributed to gaushala representatives.

The funds include Rs.7.64 crore for clearing pending liabilities from June 2024 to March 2025 and Rs.12.62 crore towards fodder expenses from April 2025 to January 2026. In addition, long-pending licenses and lease agreements of four gaushalas located in Sultanpur Dabas, Rewla Khanpur, Harewali and Surhera have been



Support is being extended for setting up biogas infrastructure MPOST

renewed, ensuring uninterrupted services for cattle care. The Chief Minister emphasised that the government is committed to improving facilities for stray animals and ensuring their dignity. "Protection of stray animals, particularly abandoned cows, is essential in a city like Delhi,"

she said, adding that gaushalas play a crucial role in providing shelter, nutrition and medical care.

Highlighting future plans, Gupta said that the government will develop 10 modern gaushalas in the first phase, equipped with improved infrastructure and facilities. She also outlined

CLOSER LOOK

» The funds include Rs 7.64 crore for clearing pending liabilities from June 2024 to March 2025 and Rs 12.62 crore towards fodder expenses from April 2025 to January 2026

» Long-pending licenses and lease agreements of four gaushalas in Sultanpur Dabas, Rewla Khanpur, Harewali and Surhera have been renewed

a broader vision to upgrade nearly 40 gaushalas across the city with better veterinary services, sanitation systems and clean energy solutions such as biogas plants. The initiative also focuses on sustainability, with support being extended for setting up biogas infrastructure using cow dung. Officials said

this would help promote clean energy while improving sanitation standards at these shelters.

Reiterating the government's approach, Gupta said, "We want gaushala managements to focus entirely on animal care without any concern," underlining the importance of removing financial and administrative hurdles.

She further noted that effective gaushala management requires collaboration beyond government support. Stressing the need for collective responsibility, she said that compassion and cooperation between society and authorities are key to ensuring better care for cattle.

Representatives of the gaushalas welcomed the move, expressing gratitude for the timely release of funds and reaffirming their commitment to the welfare and protection of stray cattle in the capital.

L-G Sandhu reviews Bhalswa, seeks faster waste processing

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: L-G Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Monday called for accelerated bioremediation of the Bhalswa Landfill and adoption of global waste management technologies, while stressing urgent fire-prevention measures ahead of the summer season.

Reviewing progress at the site, the Lieutenant Governor noted significant improvement over the past year in reducing the garbage load but said "much more needs to be done" to achieve visible and lasting outcomes.

Senior officials of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi, including Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar, briefed him on ongoing biominer operations.

Sandhu inspected trommeling machines engaged in segregating legacy and fresh waste and observed the conversion of municipal waste into refuse-derived fuel (RDF), construction material, and inert matter. He directed the civic body to deploy additional machinery to



speed up remediation, particularly in view of the continuous inflow of nearly 4,000 tonnes of fresh waste daily.

Officials said that of the 73 lakh metric tonnes of waste accumulated at the site in November 2022, a substantial portion has been processed through biominer. However, over 13 lakh metric tonnes of legacy waste and fresh waste accumulated since 2025 remain to be addressed.

Referring to Narendra Modi's 2021 remark describing Delhi's landfill sites as "mountains of shame", the Lieutenant Governor said efforts since 2022 had yielded

progress but required stronger momentum through international best practices and expert consultation.

He also underlined the need for scientific management of both legacy and fresh waste streams. With rising temperatures, he directed authorities to put in place robust systems to prevent fires at dump sites.

Emphasising citizen participation, Sandhu urged greater involvement of Resident Welfare Associations and Market Traders Associations in segregating waste at source. He also interacted with workers and called for strict enforcement of health and safety safeguards.

Delhi ramps up PNG drive, door-to-door campaigns planned: Min

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a bid to promote clean and accessible energy in the capital, Delhi Power Minister Ashish Sood on Monday chaired a high-level meeting to review the expansion of Piped Natural Gas (PNG) across the city. The meeting was attended by senior officials from Indraprastha Gas Limited (IGL), the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), Delhi Jal Board and other departments.

Following the meeting, the minister announced that a comprehensive strategy has been prepared to accelerate PNG connections and extend coverage to more households. Emphasising ease of access, he said, "The process of providing PNG connections should be made simple, transparent, and citizen-friendly."

Sood highlighted that several areas in Delhi still rely on traditional gas cylinders, despite PNG being a safer and more convenient alternative offering uninterrupted supply.



“Minister Sood highlighted that several areas still rely on traditional gas cylinders, despite PNG being a safer and more convenient alternative”

He directed officials to launch door-to-door campaigns to raise awareness and encourage adoption, especially in underserved areas.

According to officials, Delhi has the capacity to provide around 1.8 million PNG connections, of which approximately 1.4 million have already been delivered. The minister instructed authorities to work in mission mode to provide the remaining 400,000 connections at the earliest.

The government also plans to prioritise PNG usage in public welfare schemes, including Atal Canteens, night shelter kitchens, mid-day meal programmes and MCD-run kitchens. Additionally, instructions have been issued to promote PNG usage in restaurants, hotels, gurudwaras and temples.

Sood further noted that the pipeline network will be expanded rapidly, including in challenging areas such as narrow lanes and multi-storey buildings. He added that the current pace of 10,000 new connections per month could be scaled up to 25,000 if required, aiming to boost clean energy adoption and reduce pollution levels in the capital.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a major step towards strengthening water supply and sewer management in the capital, Delhi Jal Board Minister Parvash Sahib Singh on Monday unveiled the Summer Action Plan 2026-27 at Varunapala, Jhandewalan. The initiative also introduced digital tools including a chatbot, advanced CRM system, and the DJB 1916 mobile app to improve transparency and citizen engagement.

Addressing officials, the minister stressed the urgency of tackling Delhi's water challenges, stating, "I have been given the opportunity to serve Maa Yamuna, and I consider it a matter of duty and honour."

He added, "At every level, we must remember that supplying clean water is not just a service...it reflects directly on our commitment to the people of Delhi."

Under the plan, Delhi aims to maintain peak water production of around 1002 MGD during the summer, with all



Authorities have intensified leak detection drives

major water treatment plants operational. The government is also expanding tube-well infrastructure, increasing the number from 5,854 to nearly 6,290 to bridge gaps in water-deficient areas.

To ensure efficient distribution, authorities have intensified leak detection drives and maintenance of reservoirs. Around 1,221 water tankers

will be deployed monthly, supported by GPS tracking and real-time monitoring. "The tanker system is not a permanent solution. Our focus is to make it transparent and accountable while strengthening pipeline infrastructure," the minister said.

The plan also focuses on water quality, with daily testing of up to 1,700 samples and strict compliance with standards. Efforts are underway to expand pipeline coverage in unauthorized colonies and upgrade aging infrastructure.

Highlighting sewer management, the minister said, "Keeping sewer lines clean and ensuring that untreated waste does not enter the Yamuna is our direct responsibility."

The government also outlined a long-term vision to scale water treatment capacity to 1500 MGD and promote decentralized systems. "Every colony should move towards zero discharge with its own treatment system," he said, adding that sustainable water management is key to Delhi's future.

MCD inaugurates ₹12.5 crore school



ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi on Monday inaugurated a newly constructed primary school in the Karol Bagh zone, built at a cost of ₹12.5 crore, as part of its ongoing efforts to strengthen public education infrastructure.

Located at Prem Nagar near Gaushala Park in Baljit Nagar ward, the school complex spans nearly two acres. The building comprises 20 classrooms, 14 additional rooms, a multipurpose hall, and adequate sanitation facilities, along with green and recreational spaces. The campus has been designed to provide a conducive learning environment with modern amenities.

Leader of the House Pravesh Wahi said the newly constructed school reflects the civic body's commitment to improving education standards. He sought to counter the perception that private schools are superior, asserting that municipal school teachers are equally, if not more, qualified. He urged educators to remain dedicated to shaping respon-

MCD plans to develop 'Nigam Shri Vidyalayas' across wards

sible citizens. Education Committee Chairman Yogesh Verma described the school as a step towards nation-building, stating that it would play a vital role in shaping the future of students. He noted that several municipal school alumni have gone on to become civil servants, doctors, and engineers.

Verma added that over 800 municipal schools have been equipped with smart boards in line with the vision of to promote technology-driven education. He also highlighted provisions for benches through CSR initiatives and funds allocated for maintenance and sanitation improvements.

The MCD plans to develop "Nigam Shri Vidyalayas" across wards and has introduced a web application enabling parents to access student information, reflecting a broader push towards digital and infrastructural reform in civic education.

MCD proposes decriminalising minor civic offences under DMC Act overhaul

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Municipal Corporation of Delhi has proposed a set of amendments to the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act, 1957, aimed at decriminalising minor civic offences and creating a more citizen-friendly regulatory framework.

According to officials, the proposed changes seek to shift the focus from punitive enforcement to a compliance-based approach, reducing the burden of litigation and promoting cooperation between citizens and civic authorities. Several provisions that earlier attracted criminal prosecution, including fines and imprisonment for minor violations,

“Licensing norms for trades, markets, and eateries are expected to be simplified, with criminal penalties being substituted by reasonable monetary fines”

are set to be rationalised or removed.

A key feature of the amendments is the elimination of imprisonment provisions for minor municipal offences, particularly those related to technical or employment-related defaults. Authorities said this step would reduce harassment and social stigma while ensuring that minor lapses do not result in criminal liability.

The proposal also includes the removal of obsolete provisions with negligible penalties, replacing them with more practical administrative measures. Licensing norms for trades, markets, and eateries are expected to be simplified, with criminal penalties being substituted by reasonable monetary fines to encourage compliance and support ease of doing business.

While focusing on decriminalisation, the amendments also propose enhanced penalties in cases of repeated or

serious violations to maintain deterrence and ensure civic discipline.

Officials said the reforms aim to improve transparency, administrative efficiency, and trust-based governance. By reducing unnecessary legal proceedings and simplifying compliance requirements, the civic body hopes to make municipal laws more humane and practical.

The proposed amendments are in line with the broader governance vision of promoting "minimum government, maximum governance," and are expected to contribute to a more responsive and facilitative urban administration while maintaining public order, hygiene, and safety.

CCTV, STREET LIGHTING UPGRADES PLANNED

Sirsa launches ₹14 cr dev projects in Rajouri Garden

OUR CORRESPONDENT

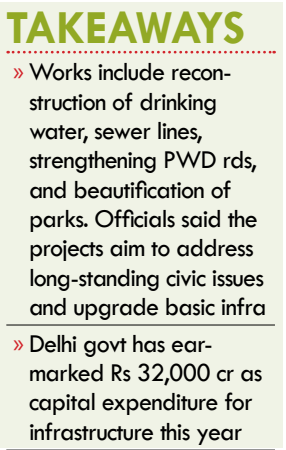
NEW DELHI: Development projects worth approximately Rs.14 crore were inaugurated in West Delhi's Rajouri Garden constituency on Monday, with a focus on improving water supply, sewer systems, roads and public spaces. The projects were launched by Cabinet Minister and local MLA Manjinder Singh Sirsa under the broader infrastructure push led by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta.

The works include reconstruction of drinking water and sewer lines, strengthening of PWD roads, and beautification of parks. Officials said the projects aim to address long-standing



ing civic issues and upgrade basic infrastructure in the area. Highlighting the scale of

investment, Sirsa said, "Delhi Government has earmarked Rs.32,000 crore as capital



expenditure for infrastructure this year, which is higher than last year's Rs.30,000 crore. This

investment will bring transformative changes across every part of Delhi."

Targeting previous administrations over civic issues, he added, "The issues of contaminated water and sewerage that we inherited due to 10-11 years of misgovernance will soon be resolved, and the people of Delhi will get relief."

The minister also underlined his commitment to fulfilling promises made to residents. "You have given us the opportunity to serve. We had promised that every road, drain, sewer, and water line in the area would be fixed, and we are fulfilling that promise," he said.

According to Sirsa, development works worth around

Rs.175 crore are already underway in Rajouri Garden within the first year. He further assured that no road would be left unattended. "During my tenure, not a single road in the Assembly will remain without redevelopment," he said, adding that both major roads and internal lanes are being upgraded.

The minister also announced plans to install modern CCTV cameras, improve street lighting, and enhance other civic amenities. Seeking public participation, he said, "If anyone feels that any development work is required in their area...they should inform us. We will ensure that no effort is spared from our side."

Trump threatens to destroy Iran’s energy...

Continued from Page 1

“No direct US talks; only excessive, unreasonable demands via intermediaries. US ‘diplomacy’ flips constantly; our stance is clear. Pakistan’s forums are their own; we didn’t participate. Regional calls to end war are welcome, but remember who started it!” the Consulate General said in a statement.

In a social media post, Trump said “great progress is being made” in talks with Iran to end military operations. But he bristled that if a deal is not reached “shortly”, and if the Strait of Hormuz is not immediately reopened, the US would broaden its offensive by “completely obliterating” power plants, oil wells, Kharg Island and possibly even desalination plants that supply drinking water.

The Strait is a crucial waterway through which a fifth of the world’s oil is shipped in peacetime.

The laws of armed conflict allow attacks on civilian infrastructure such as energy plants only if the military advantage outweighs the civilian harm,

legal scholars say. It’s considered a high bar to clear, and causing excessive suffering to civilians can constitute a war crime.

In the Financial Times interview, Trump said his preference would be to “take the oil in Iran” — a move that would require seizing Kharg Island — the terminal through which nearly all of Iran’s oil exports pass.

The US already has targeted military positions on Kharg once. Iran has threatened to launch its own ground invasion of Gulf Arab countries and mine the Persian Gulf if US troops set foot on its territory.

Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baghaei on Monday acknowledged Tehran had received a 15-point proposal from the Trump administration, but said there had been no direct negotiations with Washington. He said the US demands were “excessive, unrealistic and irrational”.

Earlier, Iran’s parliament speaker, Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf, dismissed the talks in Pakistan as a cover while more US troops are brought to the region. He said Iranian

forces were “waiting for the arrival of American troops on the ground to set them on fire and punish their regional partners forever,” according to state media.

Twice during Trump’s second term, the US has attacked Iran during high-level diplomatic talks, including with the February 28 strikes that started the current war.

Sirens sounded at dawn near Israel’s main nuclear research centre, a part of the country that has been targeted repeatedly in recent days. Israel’s military also said it had taken out two drones launched from Yemen, where the Iranian-backed Houthi rebels entered the war on Saturday with their first missile attack.

Iran kept up the pressure on its Gulf Arab neighbours. Saudi Arabia intercepted five missiles targeting its oil-rich Eastern province; a fireball erupted over Dubai, UAE , as a missile was intercepted; and in Kuwait, an Iranian attack hit a power and desalination plant, killing one worker and wounding 10 soldiers, the state-run KUNA news agency reported.

“An Iranian regime that launches ballistic missiles at homes, weaponises global trade and supports proxies is no longer an acceptable feature of the regional landscape,” Noura Al Kaabi, a minister of state at the UAE’s Foreign Ministry, wrote in a column published by the state-linked, English-language newspaper The National. She added: “We want a guarantee that this will never happen again.”

Israel launched a new wave of attacks on Iran, saying it was striking “military infrastructure” across Tehran. Explosions were heard in the Iranian capital and Iranian state media reported a petrochemicals plant in Tabriz, in the north, sustained damage in an airstrike.

In southern Lebanon, which Israel has invaded as it battles the Iran-backed Hezbollah, an Indonesian United Nations peacekeeper was killed and three others were wounded by an exploding projectile.

An Israeli airstrike on a Beirut suburb killed one person and wounded 17, including four children, according to Lebanon’s Health Ministry.

In Iran, authorities say more than 1,900 people have been killed, while 19 have been reported dead in Israel.

Two dozen people have been killed in Gulf states and the occupied West Bank. In Lebanon, officials said more than 1,200 people have been killed, and more than one million have been displaced. Six Israeli soldiers have died in Lebanon, while 13 US service members have been killed in the war.

Iran’s attacks on the energy infrastructure of the region and its stranglehold on the Strait of Hormuz have threatened global supplies of oil, natural gas and fertiliser. They have sent fuel prices skyrocketing and given rise to growing concerns about an energy crisis.

Trump has said that Iran had agreed to allow 20 oil tankers through the Strait of Hormuz starting Monday as “a sign of respect”. There wasn’t any information on whether those ships were actually moving.

Brent crude oil, the international standard, was trading around USD 115 Monday, up nearly 60 per cent from when the war started.

India, Russia discuss West Asia crisis

Rudenko also co-chaired India–Russia Foreign Office Consultations along with Foreign Secretary Misri

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India and Russia on Monday explored ways to further expand their already close strategic partnership against the backdrop of the West Asia crisis and its economic fallout.

The escalating conflict in West Asia is learnt to have figured prominently in Russian Deputy Foreign Minister Andrey Rudenko’s meetings in New Delhi including with External Affairs minister S Jaishankar.

“Good to meet Deputy Foreign Minister Andrey Rudenko of Russia. Spoke about further advancement of our wide-ranging cooperation. As well as regional and global developments,” Jaishankar said on social media.

People familiar with the meeting said the crisis in West Asia figured in the discussion.

Rudenko also co-chaired India-Russia Foreign Office Consultations along with Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri.

“Both sides reviewed the full spectrum of Special and Privi-



External Affairs minister S Jaishankar during a meeting with Deputy Minister of Foreign Affairs of Russia Andrey Rudenko, in New Delhi PTI

It is learnt that the two sides reviewed implementation of decisions taken at the summit talks between PM Modi and Russian Prez Putin last December

leged Strategic Partnership and shared perspectives on bilateral, regional and global issues of mutual interest,” External

Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said.

It is learnt that the two sides reviewed implementation of decisions taken at the summit talks between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin last December.

Following talks between the two leaders, India and Russia unveiled a raft of measures including a five-year roadmap to build a robust economic partnership and to increase the annual trade to USD 100 billion by 2030.

Retired Army brigadier killed in crossfire during road rage in Dehradun

OUR CORRESPONDENT

DEHRADUN: A routine morning walk turned fatal for a retired Army brigadier in Dehradun on Monday after he was caught in a crossfire between occupants of two cars who allegedly opened fire following a dispute over giving way on the road, police said.

The incident occurred in Johri village on Mussoorie Road in the Rajpur area early Monday when an argument over a passing manoeuvre broke out between the occupants of a Delhi-registered Fortuner and a Scorpio N, officials said.

According to the police, the Scorpio belonged to a resident of Uttarakhand, but since it was a newly purchased vehicle, it had not yet been assigned a registration number.

There were three to four people in each vehicle. Following the altercation, members of both groups allegedly opened fire at each other, Dehradun Superintendent of Police (City) Pramod Kumar told news agency. Retired Army Brigadier Mukesh Joshi (74), who was out for his morn-

ing walk in the area, was caught in the crossfire. He was rushed to a hospital but later succumbed to his injuries, Kumar said.

The officer added that Joshi lived alone in a rented flat in the Jakhan area of the city, while his family members reside in Delhi and other places.

The Fortuner went out of control during the incident and crashed into a roadside tree near the Government Primary School in Johri. The occupants of the Scorpio then allegedly assaulted the men in the Fortuner and damaged their vehicle before fleeing the scene, the SP said.

The occupants of the Fortuner -- Akhlaq, Mohit and Aadesh -- have been taken into custody and are being interrogated.

“Initially, they attempted to mislead us by claiming that the occupants of the Scorpio had opened fire on them. However, during sustained questioning, they admitted that they too were armed and had retaliated,” Kumar said.

Indian Navy staff kills woman, stores body parts in fridge in Visakhapatnam

OUR CORRESPONDENT

VISAKHAPATNAM: An Indian Navy staff allegedly murdered a 31-year-old woman, dismembered her body, and attempted to destroy the evidence in Gajuwaka area here, police said on Monday.

According to the police, the accused procured a knife online, dismembered the body of P Mounika (31), stored some parts in a refrigerator, the legs in a trolley bag, while the head and hands were placed in a separate bag inside the house. He burnt the head and hands at a vacant place near Adavivaram on Sunday.

The accused, Chintada Ravindra, working as a petty officer in the Indian Navy at INS Dega, had been in contact with Mounika since 2021 after meeting her through a dating application, police said.

“A Navy staff (Ravindra) on Sunday killed Mounika at his residence following an altercation and later dismembered the body, disposed of the parts at different locations,” said Vizag South Zone Assistant Com-

missioner of Police (ACP) Y Srinivas Rao addressing a press conference.

Later, the accused carried petrol in a plastic can to a deserted place near Darapalem and burnt the head and hands, while also cleaning blood stains inside the house with water, he said.

Unable to dispose of the remaining body parts, he left them at his residence and later voluntarily surrendered before the police, said the ACP.

The two developed a relationship over time and frequently met at various locations across Visakhapatnam, such as parks and theatres, police said.

According to the accused, the woman had allegedly taken Rs 3.5 lakh from him and threatened to reveal their relationship to his wife, leading to frequent disputes between them, the official said.

On the fateful day, the accused allegedly called her to his flat, where a heated argument broke out before he smothered her to death, the official added.

Further investigation

revealed that the accused had continued the relationship even after his marriage in 2024 and resumed contact when his wife went to her parental home for delivery, leading to escalating differences and a pre-planned intent to eliminate the Mounika.

He (Ravindra) then brutally cut the body into multiple parts including head, hands, legs and torso, using a knife, and packed them separately to avoid detection.

Meanwhile, police registered a case under sections 103(1) and 238(a) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS) Act.

During interrogation, the accused confessed to the crime, following which police recovered the burnt remains from the identified location, said Rao.

An inquest was conducted and the body parts were sent to King George Hospital (KGH) for post-mortem, while Regional Forensic Science Laboratory (RFSL) and Clue Team personnel collected physical and technical evidence from the scene.

Indian Navy gets advanced guided missile frigate, anti-submarine watercraft

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Defence PSU Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers Ltd (GRSE) on Monday delivered three front-line platforms to the Indian Navy, marking a significant milestone for indigenous defence manufacturing, an official said.

The warship-maker delivered to the Navy the advanced guided missile frigate ‘Dunagiri’, the survey vessel ‘San-shodhak’, and anti-submarine warfare shallow watercraft ‘Agray’, he said.

‘Dunagiri’, the second advanced guided missile frigate built by Garden Reach Shipbuilders and Engineers Ltd under Project 17A, is among the most sophisticated platforms built by the Kolkata-based PSU, the official said in a statement.

UP: Woman, lover, a third nabbed for killing husband in Amroha

OUR CORRESPONDENT

LUCKNOW: A 27-year-old woman was arrested along with her lover and another man in connection with the killing of her husband in Amroha’s Hasanpur, police said on Monday.

According to the police, Ruhi, the wife, pretended to sleep on a cot by her husband, when he was hacked to death allegedly by the lover and another 21-year-old man.

Superintendent of Police of Amroha Amit Kumar Anand said the incident was reported on March 29.

The victim was Mehraj, 35, a native of Piploti Kala village in Hasanpur, and a mason by profession.

“During the investigation, it came to light when the father of the deceased went to his house in the morning, he found his son lying dead on a cot. He had

sustained injury marks on his neck, hand and leg. On an adjoining cot, Meraj’s wife Ruhi lay asleep,” the officer said.

The SP said the role of the wife appeared suspicious.

When she was interrogated, Ruhi revealed that she had been having an affair with her brother-in-law, Farman, for the past at least five years.

Mehraj knew about the affair and was against it, he said.

“On Sunday night, they gave him sedatives, mixed in his dinner. At 10 pm, Farman came with his friend Adnan and attacked Meraj with a knife. Since Meraj was sleeping, he could not offer any resistance,” the SP said.

Ruhi pretended to sleep on the adjacent cot to show that her husband was attacked by some unknown persons, the officer added.

From Page 1 Spain closes

Defence Minister Margarita Robles on Monday said the same logic applied to the use of Spanish airspace in the conflict.

“This was made perfectly clear to the American military and forces from the very beginning. Therefore, neither the bases are authorised, nor, of course, is the use of Spanish airspace authorised for any actions related to the war in Iran,” Robles told reporters.

Spain’s government under Sánchez, one of Europe’s most prominent left-wing leaders, has been Europe’s loudest opposing voice against US and Israeli military actions in the Middle East.

He has called on the US, Israel and Iran to end the war, saying earlier this month: “You cannot respond to one illegality with another, because that’s how humanity’s great disasters begin.”

After Sánchez’s government denied the US use of the Rota and Morón military bases in southern Spain, US President Donald Trump threatened to cut trade with Madrid.

It was the latest flare-up between Spain and the US, which made trade threats against the European nation last year, too, when Sánchez said that his government wouldn’t increase its defence spending in accordance with a ramp-up agreed to by other NATO members following pressure from Trump.

At the time, Sánchez’s government said Spain could meet its military commitments by spending 2.1 per cent of gross domestic product on defence, instead of the 5 per cent the rest of the 32-nation military alliance agreed upon.

Sánchez was also among the most vocal critics of Israel’s actions in the war in Gaza, which

invited criticism from Israel’s government on several occasions.

“I think everyone knows Spain’s position; it’s very clear,” Robles said, calling the war in Iran “profoundly illegal and profoundly unjust.” AGENCIES

Rupee posts

94.85 before Monday’s volatile session.

Foreign institutional investor activity has further weighed on sentiment, with net equity outflows of Rs 11,163.06 crore recorded on Monday alone.

Domestic equity markets mirrored the risk-off mood, with the Sensex falling 1,635.67 points to 71,947.55 and the Nifty dropping 488.20 points to 22,331.40.

Officials have maintained that the currency remains broadly stable relative to global peers.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said India’s economic fundamentals remain strong and that the rupee is “absolutely going fine” compared to other emerging market currencies.

Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary noted that the rupee’s value is market-determined and influenced by multiple global and domestic factors, adding that authorities are closely monitoring developments.

Other Asian currencies have also weakened against the dollar since April 1, with the Japanese yen falling 6 per cent, the Philippine peso declining 5.74 per cent and the South Korean won slipping 2.88 per cent.

According to Sunal Sodhani, head of treasury at Shinhan Bank India, FY26 represents a “perfect storm” driven by external shocks, capital outflows and structural vulnerabilities. He noted that unlike FY12, when domestic factors played a larger role, the current depreciation is being driven by global forces such as oil prices, geopolitics and capital flight,

compounded by India’s import dependence.

Since the onset of the West Asia conflict on February 28, 2026, the rupee has weakened by 4.1 per cent, closing at 94.82 on March 27. Analysts expect continued volatility in the near term, with the currency likely to trade in a broad range of 92 to 97 against the US dollar, depending on oil prices, capital flows and global interest rate trends.

Nitish resigns

Sabha MP early next month, would remain in the seat of power for that long even as they are of the view that a change of guard could take place “only after Kharmaas”, an unholy month, as per the Hindu calendar, that ends on April 14.

Kharmaas is an inauspicious month-long period in the Hindu calendar that occurs twice a year when the Sun transits Sagittarius or Pisces. This year, it falls from March 15 to April 14. During this time, auspicious activities such as weddings, housewarmings and new ventures are avoided, and the period is instead considered suitable for worship, meditation and charity.

The BJP camp is thrilled at the prospect of finally having its “own chief minister” in the only Hindi heartland state where the seat of power has remained elusive, despite it having been a member of the ruling coalition for nearly two decades.

Names of many probable candidates are doing the rounds, the frontrunner being Samrat Choudhary, the Deputy Chief Minister who holds the crucial Home portfolio.

Choudhary is a Koeri, a numerically significant OBC group which has so far not been aligned with any particular party, unlike the Yadavs, who are die-hard supporters of Lalu Prasad’s

RJD, or the Kurmis who revere Nitish Kumar.

BJP sources admit that by making a Koeri the CM, the party may secure, for a long time, the support of the dominant OBC group, besides ending the perception that it was a “pro-upper caste” political force, which puts it at a disadvantage in a state like Bihar, where politics has for decades been influenced by the Mandal agitation of the 1990s.

However, some old-timers in the BJP point out that Choudhary, whom Union Home Minister Amit Shah had famously promised to make a “bada admi” (big man) during the assembly elections, may not enjoy much traction with the all powerful Sangh lobby, given the fact that he spent nearly two decades of his political career in RJD and JD(U), before joining the saffron party in 2017.

Another prominent name that is doing the rounds is that of Nityanand Rai, a former state BJP president, who is understood to be a favourite of Shah, by virtue of having been the Union Minister of State for Home.

Party sources also concede that while the new CM will be announced at a meeting of the legislative party, whenever it is held, the person occupying the seat of power will be “handpicked by the powers that be in Delhi”.

Meanwhile, JD(U) sources assert that they will insist on “a fair share” in the new cabinet, and the supremo’s son Nishant Kumar, who joined the party only recently, was likely to be pushed for the Deputy CM’s post.

Shah shreds

Be it in Naxal-affected areas, Jammu and Kashmir or the Northeast, the Modi government will not tolerate any kind of violence and will take strong action against anyone indulging in such acts, Shah asserted in the Lok

Sabha. The Home Minister made it clear that the Modi government will not spare anyone who picks up arms.

“The biggest achievement of the Modi government is a Naxal-free India: any researcher will accept this,” he said.

He said those advocating Naxalism should know that people who take up arms will have to pay a price. The solution for addressing injustice is prescribed in the Constitution. Taking up arms is not the answer, he said.

Shah also said that all credit for the success against the Maoists goes to the Central Armed Police Forces personnel, especially the brave soldiers of Cobra and CRPF, security agencies, Chhattisgarh Police, DRG personnel and tribal inhabitants.

“Today, Naxalism has been almost eradicated from Bastar. A campaign was launched to establish a school in every single village across Bastar. A drive was undertaken to open a ration shop in every village within the region. Primary Health Centres and Community Health Centres have been established in every Tehsil and Panchayat. Aadhaar cards and ration cards have been issued to the people, and they are now receiving five kilograms of food grains,” he said.

“The people of Bastar were left behind precisely because the shadow of ‘Red Terror’ loomed over the region; that is why development failed to reach them. Today, that shadow has been lifted, and Bastar is now on the path of development,” he said.

“To those advocating for dialogue, I want to reiterate what I have expressed many times from public platforms in Bastar: Lay down your arms, and the government will ensure your rehabilitation. However, they refuse to disarm, our government’s policy is clear -- we are open to dialogue with those who surrender their weapons. Those who choose violence will be met with a firm response,” he added.

Rain, snow

snowfall and rain for the second consecutive day, reducing the rainfall deficit by nearly five per cent.

“Light to moderate rain was reported across most parts of the Kashmir valley, with snowfall in higher reaches,” officials said, adding that widespread precipitation is likely over the next 24 hours.

In Himachal Pradesh, higher areas received light snowfall, with Keylong recording 2 cm, while middle and lower hills saw intermittent rain. The local meteorological office has forecast a wet spell until April 5 and issued a yellow warning for thunderstorms, lightning and gusty winds in several districts.

Temperatures in Haryana and Punjab remained near normal, with Chandigarh recording a maximum of 31.9 degrees Celsius.

Meanwhile, the IMD issued an orange alert for hailstorms in five northeastern districts of Jharkhand on Tuesday, alongside a yellow alert for thunderstorms in the remaining districts.

Census 2027

Midway through comes Population Enumeration – slated mostly for February 2027, though snowy zones begin before then.

Out there, teams dig into details: who people are and how they earn, learn, move, or raise families. Alongside that, records of caste take shape too. Marking time differently in remote hills, the count freezes at midnight, October 1, 2026; elsewhere it waits until March 1, 2027.

This round looks different because tech plays a big role now. Right after collection, data flows straight into systems through smartphones used by field staff. Filling forms yourself online becomes an option for everyone.

In total, sixteen tongues are welcome on both digital paths – one being Hindi and another English. A new way of handling daily work has started, using computers to make ID tags, hand out jobs, and teach workers what they need to know, while also watching how things move forward.

People in charge stress that keeping information safe matters a lot right now. This massive count includes every state and territory – thirty-six in total – alongside more than seven thousand sub-districts, nearly ten thousand towns, and close to 639,000 villages. Funding worth Rs 11,718.24 crore got the green light from national authorities, meant for tech tools, transport needs, staff learning sessions, and wages for those collecting data. Presently, training rolls out nationwide in phases, touching roughly 3.1 million people who will soon conduct door-to-door surveys. Come January first, 2026, boundary lines stay put until spring of next year. Back in November 2025, trial runs popped up across roughly five thousand small zones to check how well the updated tools worked. Starting with digital tools, the 2027 census plans to shift how India gathers headcount details – making it smoother, sharper, and still simpler. That move? It signals progress within the nation’s information backbone.

ATF supplies

In a written reply on post-accident safety checks, the minister referred to a July 2025 directive issued by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation. The order required operators to inspect fuel control switch locking mechanisms in Boeing aircraft, following guidance from the Federal Aviation Administration. According to Naidu, all airlines completed the inspections and the aircraft were cleared as fit for operation.

‘CONGRESS ALLOWED ILLEGAL LAND GRABBING BY INFILTRATORS’

PM: Infiltration not just poll issue but about safeguarding national security

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Accusing the Congress of “allowing” land grabbing by infiltrators, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said on Monday that infiltration into Assam is not just an election issue but is about safeguarding the identity of the state and national security.

Addressing virtually the BJP’s booth-level workers in Assam ahead of the April 9 Assembly polls, Modi said that the state saw a long span of instability but things changed over the past decade as the party’s double-engine government made every effort to ensure peace.

There is a need to remind first-time voters of the “misrule” of previous Congress governments in Assam and caution them that even the smallest mistake can push the state back, he said, noting that the BJP members were working hard to ensure a hat-trick for the party in the state.



PM Narendra Modi

ing hard to ensure a hat-trick for the party in the state.

“Infiltration is not just an election issue. It is an issue to safeguard the identity of Assam and national security. Congress allowed illegal land grabbing by infiltrators.

“Wherever infiltrators settle, they capture small businesses and the livelihoods of local people,” he said during the ‘Mera Booth, Sabse Mazboot Samvaad’ initiative by

the ruling BJP that is aimed at connecting directly with party activists in poll-bound states.

The Prime Minister said the BJP workers must be fully aware of illegal land grabbing cases and the problems faced by local people, and the ordeal of those who have suffered due to illegal infiltrators must be known.

“People must know that Congress allowed encroach-

Highlights

- » Modi said that the state saw a long span of instability but things changed over the past decade
- » PM said BJP workers must be fully aware of illegal land grabbing cases and problems faced by local people

ment, but the BJP is protecting rights,” he said.

Modi noted that 12 peace agreements were signed by the government with different organisations in the Northeast. He said the BJP workers must remind people how the Congress “used to make agreements only on paper to create headlines and mislead people”.

“We have seen the era when Assam was burning in violence. Assam saw a long span of insta-

bility, but things have changed in the past decade. But today, we can see a new confidence as the BJP’s double-engine government has made every effort for peace,” he said.

Under the Congress, peace agreements were pushed aside and the youths were left to suffer and drift towards unrest, Modi alleged.

“No agreement with insurgents and student organisations worked during the Congress rule in Assam. The Congress betrayed the Bodo cause.

“The BJP worked to establish peace and secure the future of the youth. We are sincerely implementing peace agreements on the ground. Assam has witnessed how peace has been established through honest efforts in the past decade,” he said.

Modi also said that the culture of the Bodo tribal areas is rich, but for decades, the Congress had neglected the region.

Uttar Pradesh completes verification of 3.26 crore voters under SIR drive

Final list to be published on April 10

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The Election Commission has completed hearings for 3.26 crore voters in Uttar Pradesh under the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) campaign, claiming that action has been taken on 100 per cent of the notices issued during the process.

Officials said the final electoral roll will be published on April 10 and is expected to include more than 13.25 crore voters. The previous voter list had around 12.55 crore names. During the SIR exercise, over one crore entries were flagged due to mismatch with the 2003 voter list, while more than two crore names were found to have logical discrepancies.

According to the Commission, special arrangements were made to make the SIR process voter friendly. Hearings related to document verification notices were conducted near the residences of voters. In as many as 2.22 crore cases, Booth Level Officers carried out door to door verification.

The drive also saw a large number of applications for inclusion and deletion of names. A total of 86.69 lakh applications were received for adding new voters, while 3.18 lakh requests were filed for deletion. Officials said that more than 97 per cent of the names are likely to remain on the final list.

The Chief Electoral Officer has clarified that no voter’s

Closer Look

- » The previous voter list had around 12.55 crore names
- » The drive also saw a large number of applications for inclusion and deletion of names
- » A total of 86.69 lakh applications were received for adding new voters
- » Chief Electoral Officer has clarified that no voter’s name will be removed without due process and proper hearing

name will be removed without due process and proper hearing. The entire exercise, officials said, has been conducted in a transparent manner. The objective of the SIR campaign is to ensure a clean, accurate and updated electoral roll by removing duplicate, deceased, shifted or ineligible voters and adding eligible new voters.

The exercise, however, has drawn criticism from political parties, particularly those in the Opposition, which have alleged that the process is being used to deliberately remove names of their supporters. With the publication of the final list approaching, attention is now focused on the outcome, which could trigger fresh claims and objections.

Lok Sabha Speaker meets European Parliament delegation

NEW DELHI: Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on Monday met a European Parliament Delegation for Relations with India (D-IN) led by Angelika Niebler at the Parliament House here, with discussions focusing on strengthening strategic relations between India and the EU.

According to a statement issued by the Lok Sabha, Speaker Birla expressed satisfaction over the first meeting of the Parliamentary Friendship Group for the European Union held with the visiting delegation, terming it a “significant step in institutionalising legislative engagement between the two sides.”

The discussions highlighted the growing strength of the India-EU strategic partnership, with both sides emphasising shared democratic values and common global interests.

The statement said Parliamentary exchanges remain a key pillar of bilateral cooperation, providing an important platform for dialogue and mutual learning.



Sonia Gandhi shows ‘progress’, discharge expected soon: Doctors

NEW DELHI: Senior Congress leader Sonia Gandhi has made “excellent progress” and is now “absolutely normal”, with a decision on her discharge expected soon, doctors said on Monday.

She was admitted to Sir Ganga Ram Hospital on March 24, around 10.22 pm, after developing a fever.

According to hospital chairman Ajay Swaroop, Gandhi remains on IV antibiotics, which will continue for a few more days, though all her parameters are within normal limits.

“The decision regarding her discharge will be taken jointly after discussion with the patient and the treating physician. Otherwise, she is hale and hearty,” he said.

Doctors said she is undergoing treatment for a systemic infection and is responding well to antibiotics.

AGENCIES

Flags Registrar General’s Remarks Cong: No reason for ‘bulldozing’ Constitution amendment Bills

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Congress on Monday cited Census Commissioner Mritunjay Kumar Narayan’s remarks that many Census data sets will be published in 2027 itself to claim that the grounds on which Constitution amendment Bills are being sought to be “bulldozed” through Parliament are “false”.

In a post on X, the Congress general secretary in-charge of communications, Jairam Ramesh, said, “Constitution amendment Bills are being sought to be bulldozed through in the next few days on the grounds that Census results will not be available since 2029.”

“This information given by the RG&CCI proves that these grounds are false,” he said and tagged a post on Narayan’s remarks that the first set of Census data will be issued in 2027.

‘This information given by the RG&CCI proves that these grounds are false’

Registrar General of India and Census Commissioner Narayan on Monday asked people to give accurate information to Census enumerators, asserting that the individual data will remain confidential and cannot be used as evidence or for getting any benefit under any scheme.

Addressing a press conference, Narayan said, “Earlier, data was collected on physical paper which took a lot of time in digitisation. We will start getting digital data right from the start, hence we will be able to issue such data very early. Many data sets will be published in 2027 itself.”

Biju-CIA link row: Patnaik says Nishikant Dubey needs to consult ‘mental doctor’

BJD MP Sasmit Patra resigned from a Parliamentary committee headed by Dubey over the latter’s remarks

OUR CORRESPONDENT

BHUBANESWAR: BJD president Naveen Patnaik on Monday said BJP MP Nishikant Dubey needs to consult a “mental doctor” for making “outrageous” remarks against freedom fighter and former Odisha chief minister Biju Patnaik.

Condemning Dubey’s comments, the BJD chief said, “I think the BJP MP needs some mental doctor’s attention for saying these outrageous things.”

Dubey, in a statement on March 27, had claimed that Biju Patnaik was the link between former Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru and the CIA during the war against China in the 1960s.

As the issue snowballed into a major controversy with BJD MPs staging a walkout from the Rajya Sabha on Monday, alleging “disrespectful and defamatory” remarks made by Dubey against Biju Patnaik, the BJP lawmaker in a post on X clarified that he made the statement while exposing the “misdeeds of the Congress and not Biju Patnaik.”

Further clarifying his stand on the issue, Dubey said that Biju Patnaik was a tall freedom fighter and the BJP respects him.

Dubey had claimed that Biju Patnaik was the link between former PM Nehru and the CIA during war against China in 1960s

fied that he made the statement while exposing the “misdeeds of the Congress and not Biju Patnaik.”

Further clarifying his stand on the issue, Dubey said that Biju Patnaik was a tall freedom fighter and the BJP respects him.

“When Congress did injus-

tice to Biju Babu, it was the Jan Sangh and the BJP which stood by him. Tell me, which allegation did I level at Biju Babu in my tweet? If anyone is hurt by what I have written in my tweets, then I can only try to make them understand,” Dubey said.

He further said Biju Babu

is respected and will remain so. “I do not need anyone’s certificate,” Dubey said in the social media post.

He claimed that Biju Patnaik was also the “pride of Bihar” as Odisha was part of Bihar before 1936.

“I denounce the idea of confining national heroes in region, caste and creed,” he said. Earlier in the day, the BJD president told reporters outside the Assembly, “I am surprised at Dubey’s outrageous remarks. I do not think

that Nehru had set up an office next to his in Delhi, while Biju Babu was still the chief minister of Odisha, to carry out tactics and fight the Chinese.”

Meanwhile, BJD MP Sasmit Patra resigned from a Parliamentary committee headed by Dubey over the latter’s remarks.

At least four other MPs -- Manas Mangaraj, Subhashish Khuntia, Muzibulla Khan and Niranjan Bishi -- criticised the BJP MP and accused him of “insulting the pride of Odisha”.

PM Modi, Dutch PM Rob Jetten discuss strategic ties in phone conversation

NEW DELHI: Dutch Prime Minister Rob Jetten on Monday held a phone conversation with his Indian counterpart Narendra Modi that focused on boosting India-Netherlands strategic partnership including in areas of defence, innovation and trade.

Jetten was sworn in as the prime minister of the Netherlands last month. He is the youngest leader to hold the top post in the European nation.

It is learnt that the West Asia crisis and its economic impact figured in conversation between the two prime ministers.

“Our ties with India are growing stronger and stronger. Earlier this year, the EU and India concluded a major trade agreement, and the Netherlands and India are developing a strategic partnership that includes defence, water management, innovation and trade,” the Dutch leader said on social media.

Nation Briefs

BJP FIELDS LATE MLA’S SON FOR UMRETH ASSEMBLY BYPOLL IN GUJARAT

AHMEDABAD: The ruling Bharatiya Janata Party on Monday selected Harshad Parmar, son of former BJP MLA Govind Parmar, for the upcoming byelection to Umreth Assembly constituency in Gujarat. Govind Parmar, who represented Umreth seat in Anand district, died on March 6 at the age of 72 following a brief illness, necessitating the byelection. The Election Commission has scheduled the bypoll for April 23. “Harshad Govindbhai Parmar has been selected as the party’s candidate for the bypoll to Umreth Assembly constituency,” a release from the BJP’s central headquarters said. This would be his first major election. Other political parties, including Congress, are yet to announce their candidates.

NCP (SP) LEADER KHADSE, HIS DAUGHTER BOOKED FOR CHEATING, FORGERY

MUMBAI: Nationalist Congress Party (SP) MLC Eknath Khadse and his daughter were booked for allegedly cheating an elderly woman by assuring a sugar factory on her land and taking its possession with the help of forged papers in Maharashtra’s Jalgaon district, police said on Monday. The land in question was classified as ‘Mahar Watan’ and its illegal possession was taken in the name of former state minister Khadse’s daughter Sharda from the 82-year-old woman, they said. Notably, ‘Watan’ lands are ‘inam’ (gift from a ruler to a subject). It refers to land traditionally granted to Mahar community members (now in Scheduled Caste category) as compensation for performing hereditary village duties by erstwhile rulers.

‘NOT TO BE USED FOR SCHEME BENEFITS’

Individual Census data to remain ‘confidential’

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India, Mritunjay Kumar Narayan, on Monday asked people to provide accurate information to census enumerators, asserting that individual data will remain confidential and cannot be used as evidence or to obtain any benefit under any scheme.

Addressing a press conference, as the first phase of the country's 16th Census is all set to begin in April in some states, including Delhi, the commissioner said that under Section 15 of the Census Act, all individual data remains confidential. The first phase of the Census will be conducted in Delhi from April 16 to May 15. "All individual data collected during the exercise remains confidential. It cannot be shared with any organisation, be it government or private, under the Right to Information Act, or used as evi-



Census Commissioner Mritunjay Kumar Narayan with other officials during a press conference on Census of India 2027, at the National Media Centre in New Delhi

dence in a court," Narayan said. Only statistical aggregate data will be used for tabulation purposes, he added.

Asked about caste being included in the Census and the apprehension that people may not furnish correct information, Narayan said the data related to caste will be collected during the second phase, and the questions will be decided after exhaustive discussions.

"There are many suggestions on how to collect caste information. All those will be

considered, and the best will be put forth before finalising questions," he said.

"Individual information cannot be used for any purpose. Only aggregate statistical information is made public. Individual data cannot be used to derive any benefit from any scheme. There is no such provision. Hence, the manipulation you are apprehending is not possible," Narayan said.

The last comprehensive caste-based count was done between 1881 and 1931. Caste

was excluded from all census operations conducted since Independence.

The Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs, chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, decided to include caste enumeration in the upcoming census on April 30 last year.

Narayan said that strict measures are in place for digital security, in conformity with the norms set by the Indian agencies. He also made it clear that no documents shall be collected during the exercise.

‘Phase-1 to have 33 questions’

NEW DELHI: The government has notified a set of 33 questions to be asked during the first phase of Census 2027 -- Housing Listing and Housing Operations (HLO) -- a month-long exercise to be conducted between April 1 and September 30 as per schedules finalised by states and Union Territories, a top official said on Monday.

Narayan, said, according to a January 22 notification, enumerators will collect details such as building number (municipal or local authority or census number), census house number, and the predominant materials used for the floor, walls, and roof. They will also record the use and condition of the house and assign a household number.

They will also ask about the total number of usual residents in the household, name and sex of the head of the household, whether the head belongs to a Scheduled Caste, Scheduled Tribe or other category, ownership status of the house, number of dwelling rooms and the number of married couples in the household, he said.

Enumerators will also gather information on amenities and assets, including the main source and availability of drinking water, source of lighting, access to and type of latrine, wastewater outlet, availability of bathing and kitchen facilities, LPG/PNG connection, and the primary cooking fuel, Narayan said.

Data on possession of items such as radio, television, internet access, laptop/computer, telephone/mobile/smartphone, bicycle/scooter/motorcycle/moped, and car/jeep/van will also be collected, along with the main cereal consumed and a mobile number for census-related communication, he said.

MPOST

CENSUS 2027

Live-in couple in ‘stable union’ to be treated as married

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: If a live-in couple considers their relationship as a "stable union", they should be treated as "married" for the 16th Census, according to the FAQ section on the self-enumeration portal.

The portal, opened for people opting for self-enumeration, will be available for both phases of the Census -- 'Houselisting and Housing Census' and 'Population Enumeration'.

It has an FAQ (Frequently Asked Questions) section to help people answer the queries in the Census.

One such FAQ was on live-in relationships. "Will a couple in a live-in relationship be considered a married couple?" The Answer: "If they consider their relationship as a stable union, they should be treated as a married couple."

The section provides guidance on several tricky questions, such as "My house has different flooring materials in different rooms. There is only one option to select under 'material of floor'. Which one should I select?"

"If different rooms have different flooring, record the material used predominantly. For example: If only the drawing room has mosaic but all other rooms have cement, record 'Cement'. If only the bathroom has cement but all other rooms have tiles or mosaic, record 'Mosaic/Floor Tiles', the FAQ section states.

"If the house has marble flooring, but it is not listed in the options, then select 'Stone', it says.

To the question, "In my region, we use bamboo or Ekra for walls. But there is no such option listed for walls. Which option should I select then?" the FAQ section advises people to select the "Grass/thatch/bamboo etc" option.

INSIGHT

» The portal, opened for people opting for self-enumeration, will be available for both phases of the Census -- 'Houselisting and Housing Census' and 'Population Enumeration'

» Regarding the name of a caste or tribe that is not listed under the options, the FAQ reply suggests clicking the 'Other' option

Regarding the name of a caste or tribe that is not listed under the options, the FAQ reply suggests clicking the "Other" option.

It says that each state and Union Territory has its own notified list of scheduled castes and scheduled tribes.

"The Census of India has compiled it and provided the list of castes for all states/UTs. If your caste or tribe name is not listed under your state/UT's caste list, you can select 'Other' from the option," it says.

Another tricky question is: "I share a room with another household member. Can it be counted as a dwelling room by me?" The Answer: "No. Only rooms exclusively used by your household should be counted."

Consider this: "If I keep tap water in bottles. Can I consider it as bottled water?"

"No, it is still considered tap water," the FAQ section states.

One of the questions seeks to know if a mobile phone has FM, should it be counted as 'radio' available, to which the FAQ says, "Yes. Record 'On Mobile/Smartphone'."

To the question "If I listen to music on Carvaan, what type of radio should I record?" the answer is to choose "Any other device."

Identify locations for water harvesting systems: Haryana CM Saini to officials

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday directed the officials to identify suitable locations for installing water harvesting systems across the state.

Chairing a meeting with the officers of the Urban Local Bodies Department here, Saini directed the officials to take concrete arrangements to address the waterlogging issues that arise during the monsoon season.

During the meeting, he reviewed in detail the pre-monsoon preparations, including drain cleaning, water drainage systems, and sanitation arrangements, and issued necessary directions to the concerned officers.

He directed that areas facing drainage issues should be identified, and alternative solutions should be adopted.

Officials were told to take concrete steps to address the waterlogging issues that arise during the monsoon

Saini particularly emphasised exploring the option of installing water harvesting systems at such locations to enable rainwater conservation and significantly reduce waterlogging problems.

The chief minister further directed the officers to prepare comprehensive and updated data related to water harvesting in the state.

This should include details of locations where such systems are already installed, how many are

functioning properly, and where new installations are required.

He said that these systems should be effectively implemented across all government departments, and where these systems have not yet been installed, they should be set up on a priority basis, especially in waterlogging-prone areas.

Saini also held detailed discussions on further improving the sanitation system in the state.

The officers apprised the chief minister that modern technology, particularly implementing a radio frequency identification (RFID)-based system for door-to-door garbage collection, is being used to strengthen sanitation management, leading to improved monitoring and transparency. Continuous efforts are being made in this direction.

All HC: Interfaith live-in relationship not ‘offence’

PRAYAGRAJ: The Allahabad High Court has held that an interfaith live-in relationship is neither prohibited nor an offence under any law, while granting protection to a couple facing threats from the woman's family.

Allowing a petition filed by Kajal Prajapati and her Muslim partner from Sonbhadra, Justice Vivek Kumar Singh observed that merely being in an interfaith relationship does not deprive individuals of their fundamental rights guaranteed under the Constitution.

"No discrimination can be made on the basis of caste, creed, sex or religion," the court said. The couple had approached the court seeking protection from the woman's family, claiming that their pleas to police had gone unheeded.

No discrimination can be made on the basis of caste, creed, sex or religion

The state government's counsel informed the court that the petitioners are majors and no FIR has been registered against them for living together. The court said the petitioners are at liberty to approach the police for redressal of their grievances in case any harm is caused to them. It further directed police to examine the matter and the age of the petitioners. "Police must act in accordance with the law if they find any substance in the allegations of the petitioners." AGENCIES

Mohali: Saini honours achievers at Disha Awards

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini honoured citizens for outstanding contributions across fields at the sixth Disha Indian Awards held in Mohali.

At the event organised by the Disha Women Welfare Trust, he said the occasion celebrates struggles, dreams and commitments that have helped shape a progressive society. He noted that the awards reflect an India advancing on the strength of women. As many as 26 individuals were recognised for their work towards women's upliftment. Saini described them as true heroes who selflessly contributed to social development.

MPOST

Govt scraps CISF ‘Hardship Allowance’

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: In a major policy change, the government has stopped the hardship allowance for personnel of the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF), impacting thousands of officers and personnel across various units. The order from CISF Headquarters will take effect on April 1, 2026.

The decision affects members posted in 55 CISF units, including important sites like BSL Bokaro, BCCL Dhanbad, and CCL Kargali. With the allowance's removal, both gazetted and non-gazetted personnel will no longer receive the extra monthly financial benefit that had been in place since 2017.

Previously, under guidance from the Ministry of Home Affairs, personnel in units located in Naxal-affected areas were eligible for a hardship allowance. Constables to Inspectors received Rs 10,000 per month, while officers from Assistant Commandant to DIG rank earned Rs 17,000 per month in addition to their salaries.

However, the government has now chosen to end the allowance as part of its broader goal related to the target of a Naxal-free India by March 31, 2026. Officials noted this move also aims to reduce spending since the benefit was extended in some regions not directly impacted by Naxal activity.

The withdrawal will directly affect nearly 15,000 CISF personnel deployed in various units, especially in the eastern sector under Ranchi, which includes 43 of the 55 impacted units. At the same time, this decision is expected to generate significant savings for public sector undertakings and other organizations that were covering these allowances.

Estimates indicate that about Rs 200 crore per month could be saved after the allowance is discontinued.

UP: Baghpat man disowned by family after marrying Kumbh fame Monalisa

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

BAGHPAT: A resident of Palri village in Uttar Pradesh's Baghpat district has been disowned by his family after marrying Monalisa, who had come into the spotlight during the Prayagraj Maha Kumbh for selling Rudraksha beads.

Farman Khan's family has severed all relations with him following the marriage, with his father Jafar Ali stating that the family no longer maintains any connection with their son. Family members have also stopped communicating with him.

According to Jafar Ali, the decision was taken after Farman married without the family's consent. He said the

family is not in touch with him since the marriage and has no intention of restoring ties. He added that formal legal steps may also be taken to officially disown him.

Farman had met Monalisa around six months ago in Mumbai at his studio. The two later met several times on the sets of a film titled The Diary of Manipur, where their relationship developed into a romantic involvement. The couple reportedly married at a temple in Kerala and later registered their marriage on March 11.

The marriage has since triggered controversy. Initially, objections were raised by Monalisa's family, followed by allegations from the film's

director. The dispute escalated further when Monalisa levelled accusations against director Sanjay Mishra.

Amid the growing row and the circumstances surrounding the marriage, Farman's family has distanced itself completely. Jafar Ali said that earlier he used to speak to his son regularly, and Farman would visit home once or twice a year. During these visits, he often claimed to be working on film projects and had taken money from the family on several occasions.

However, the father said there has been no communication from Farman after the marriage, and the family too has chosen to cut off all contact.

‘A SOLDIER SIGNS OFF’

Western Command chief Lt Gen Manoj Kumar Katiyar bids farewell to service

SONIKA BHATIA

CHANDIGARH: With quiet dignity befitting a soldier of his stature, Lieutenant General Manoj Kumar Katiyar, PVSM, UYSM, AVSM, will demit office as General Officer Commanding-in-Chief of Western Command on March 31, drawing the curtain on a military career that has spanned more than four decades.

Commissioned into the 23rd Battalion of the Rajput Regiment in the summer of 1986, Lt Gen Katiyar's journey mirrors the arc of a soldier shaped by the rigours of service and the demands of command. From the icy vastness of the Siachen Glacier to the tense stretches of India's frontiers, his career has unfolded across terrains that test both endurance and resolve.

Those who have served with him speak of a commander grounded in professionalism, yet forward-looking in his approach. Whether in the corridors of strategic planning as Director General of Military Operations, or in the field com-



manding one of the Army's premier formations, his emphasis remained constant—preparedness, cohesion, and clarity of purpose.

At Western Command, one of the Army's most crucial operational theatres, his tenure has been marked by steady consolidation. There has been a visible push towards modernisation, including the integration of emerging technologies, even as equal attention has been paid to the welfare of soldiers and their families—a balance that defines enduring leadership.

Educated at institutions such as Sainik School Ghorakhal,

the National Defence Academy, and the Indian Military Academy, and later refined through higher military studies in India and abroad, Lt Gen Katiyar represents a generation of officers equally at ease with field command and strategic thought.

Decorated with some of the nation's highest peacetime military honours, his career has been one of quiet accomplishment rather than overt display—an embodiment of the Army's enduring ethos.

In his farewell remarks, he chose not to dwell on personal milestones but on collective effort—acknowledging

KEY POINTS

- » Commissioned into the 23rd Battalion of the Rajput Regiment in 1986, Lt Gen Katiyar's journey mirrors the arc of a soldier shaped by the rigours of service and the demands of command
- » He will demit office as General Officer Commanding-in-Chief of Western Command on March 31

soldiers, fellow services, civil administration, and the people whose support underpins military readiness. It was a reminder that the strength of an institution lies not in individuals alone, but in the shared commitment of many.

As Lt Gen Katiyar steps away from uniform, he leaves behind not just a record of service, but a legacy of steadiness and purpose. In an era of evolving challenges, such leadership remains both relevant and reassuring.

He now turns a new chapter in Lucknow—away from the frontlines, yet forever a soldier at heart.



Union minister Jitendra Singh addresses a Technology Transfer event

developed technology, this bio-mass, such as paddy straw, can now be processed into a renewable binder for road construction, potentially saving up to Rs 40,000 crore in annual imports for India, Union minister Jitendra Singh said.

Addressing a Technology Transfer event, the minister described the conversion of crop residue into bio-bitumen as a "transformative shift" that aligns environmental goals with economic gains.

India generates nearly 600 million tonnes of agricultural waste annually, much of which is burnt, contributing to severe air pollution. Through indigenously

a paradigm shift in how rural waste streams are integrated into industrial supply chains. The approach, they said, not only addresses environmental concerns but also opens new income streams for farmers, who can now monetise crop residue rather than burn it.

Director General of CSIR N. Kalaiselvi described the transition from petro-based binders to renewable alternatives as a structural shift in industrial thinking. She noted that the technology had already seen early adoption, with pilot road projects demonstrating durability and reduced carbon emissions.

The minister stressed the need for effective outreach, noting that technological innovations must be communicated in accessible formats to farmers and other stakeholders to ensure large-scale adoption.

Hry: Congress MLAs to visit Mandis over procurement ‘grievances’

CHANDIGARH: Congress MLAs in Haryana will visit mandis across the state to assess farmers' difficulties in wheat and mustard procurement and raise the issue forcefully. The decision was taken at a Congress Legislature Party meeting chaired by Leader of Opposition Bhupinder Singh Hooda.

The party alleged that the BJP government is indulging in irregularities under the guise of crop procurement. Several state issues were discussed, with plans to hold district-level meetings across Haryana in May.

Newly elected Rajya Sabha MP Karamvir Baudh thanked MLAs for their support. The Congress also decided to approach the Election Commission over alleged wrongful cancellation of votes and will move the High Court on the issue. Haryana Congress president Rao Narendra Singh said a disciplinary panel meeting on cross-voting is set for April 3.

MPOST

Nation Briefs

NEW WEEKLY TRAIN BETWEEN ANAND VIHAR-PURULIA FROM APRIL 2

HAJIPUR: To enhance passenger convenience, the Railways will introduce a new weekly train between Anand Vihar Terminal and Purulia from April 2. Train no. 14022/14021 Anand Vihar–Purulia–Anand Vihar Express will run every Thursday from Anand Vihar and return every Friday from Purulia. The train will operate via key stations including Varanasi, Dehri-on-Sone, Garhwa Road and Ranchi. It will have 22 coaches, including AC and sleeper classes. The service is expected to improve connectivity across Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, and Jharkhand, benefiting long-distance travellers, the East Central Railway said.

NFR DEPLOYS ADVANCED OFC-BASED COMMUNICATION SYSTEM AT LC GATES

MALIGAON: The Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) has introduced an advanced OFC-based Integrated Voice-cum-Data Communication System at Level Crossing (LC) Gates to enhance safety and operational efficiency. The system is being implemented across 50 LC Gates using the robust Optical Fibre Cable (OFC) network of Indian Railways, ensuring reliable and uninterrupted communication between Station Masters and gate operators. The system enables both audio and visual monitoring of LC Gates.





EDITORIAL

BEYOND GPS
DEPENDENCE

India's technological rise is often narrated through rockets, lunar missions and record satellite launches. But some of its most consequential advances operate quietly, almost invisibly, shaping systems that citizens depend on every day. The Navigation with Indian Constellation (NavIC) falls squarely into that category. It does not command the spectacle of a moon landing, yet it represents something arguably more foundational: control over how a nation understands space, time and movement within its own geography. In a world where geopolitics increasingly extends into orbit, navigation is no longer just a utility—it is infrastructure, sovereignty and strategy rolled into one.

For decades, global navigation has been dominated by systems such as the United States' GPS, Russia's GLONASS, Europe's Galileo and China's BeiDou. These systems are reliable, but they are not neutral. Access can be degraded, denied or prioritised depending on strategic interests. India learned this lesson during the Kargil conflict, when access to high-precision GPS data was restricted. NavIC, developed by the Indian Space Research Organisation, is therefore not merely a technological project; it is a strategic correction. By building its own regional navigation system, India has ensured that critical sectors—from defence to disaster response—are no longer dependent on external signals that it does not control.

Yet, the real test of such a system lies not in its existence, but in its adoption. Here, the picture is still evolving. While India has launched 11 satellites under NavIC, with eight currently operational, only a subset is actively broadcasting full navigation signals. The system today supports a mix of services—positioning, timing and one-way messaging—but its integration into everyday civilian use remains limited. Discussions with aviation authorities on incorporating NavIC into air traffic management are a step in the right direction, but they also underline a larger issue: technological capability must be matched by institutional uptake. Without widespread integration across transport, logistics, smartphones and emergency services, NavIC risks remaining underutilised.

That would be a missed opportunity, because the potential is significant. A robust, fully operational NavIC ecosystem could transform multiple sectors simultaneously. Real-time train tracking, already under exploration, can improve safety and efficiency across one of the world's largest rail networks. For fishermen operating in deep seas, NavIC-enabled devices can provide precise positioning and emergency alerts, often the difference between safety and tragedy. In urban India, vehicle tracking systems linked to NavIC could strengthen passenger safety frameworks, particularly for public transport. Even something as fundamental as the dissemination of Indian Standard Time—critical for banking, telecommunications and digital infrastructure—can be made more precise and secure through indigenous satellite systems.

There is also a deeper industrial dimension. For NavIC to succeed, it must move beyond being a state-led initiative and become part of a broader ecosystem involving device manufacturers, app developers and service providers. The introduction of the L1 band for civilian use is an important step, improving compatibility with global systems and making it easier for smartphone manufacturers to integrate NavIC chips. But adoption will require policy nudges—mandates in certain sectors, incentives for industry, and a clear roadmap that signals long-term commitment. India has seen this playbook succeed before, most notably with UPI, where a combination of public infrastructure and private innovation created a globally recognised digital payments system. NavIC, too, needs that push from infrastructure to ubiquity.

Ultimately, the significance of NavIC lies in what it represents rather than what it immediately delivers. It signals a shift in how India approaches critical technologies—not as optional capabilities, but as essential pillars of national resilience. In an era where conflicts can disrupt supply chains, communication networks and digital systems, the ability to independently determine position and time is not a luxury. It is a baseline requirement. NavIC may still be a work in progress, with gaps in coverage and adoption, but its direction is clear. The challenge now is to move from capability to confidence—from a system that exists to one that is used, trusted and embedded across the economy. If that transition is achieved, NavIC will not just guide navigation; it will mark India's steady arrival as a nation that builds, controls and secures its own technological future.

POWER
LINES



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS
A RETIRED IPS
OFFICER, ADVISER
NATSTRAT, AND A
FORMER NATIONAL
SECURITY ADVISOR
IN MAURITIUS

Kent's objections—centred on the absence of an imminent Iranian threat and the perceived influence of Israel on U.S. policy—may be controversial, but they are not isolated

Fallout of the Conflict

Joe Kent's exit is not an isolated act—it signals deeper discomfort within a coalition now confronting the consequences of prolonged military engagement

The heat generated by the ongoing military conflict in the Israel-US-Iran war has now entered its fourth phase and is being widely felt. In a recent move, Joe Kent, a top U.S. counterterrorism official, has resigned over the Iran war. Kent is the highest-ranking Trump administration official to quit in opposition to the conflict. He is also largely known for his support for conspiracy theories. Elaborating on his opposition to the war in Iran, he stated what he believed was Israel's influence over the Trump administration's policies. Some experts say that this is an indication of emerging divisions in the Republican coalition. It is also assessed in some U.S. quarters that the open-ended nature of the U.S.-Israeli war in Iran has created strong fissures among Trump's supporters. An anti-interventionist wing of the coalition, which supported President Donald Trump because of his criticism of long overseas conflicts, has suddenly changed its course, as the war shows no immediate sign of ending. Kent, the Director of the National Counterterrorism Center, wrote in a letter to President Trump that Iran posed no imminent threat to the U.S., and according to him, it is clear that the U.S. has started this war due to pressure from Israel and its powerful American lobby. Kent's resignation has possibly surprised everyone.

A few anti-Trump elements also reckon that, encouraged by Kent's resignation, more officials may tender their resignations. Following Kent's exit, Trump commented, "I always thought he was a nice guy, but I always thought he was weak on security." The U.S. President further said that "it's a good thing that he's out because he said Iran was not a threat." This has reportedly put Tulsi Gabbard, the Director of National Intelligence (DNI) and Kent's boss, in an embarrassing position. After carefully reviewing all the information before him, President Trump concluded that the Islamist regime in Iran posed an imminent threat and took action based on that conclusion, as noted by Gabbard.

It is also relevant to mention, as carried in The New York Times, that Kent is not an ordinary war critic. He has long had a penchant for conspiracy theories, suggesting without evidence that F.B.I. agents could have been responsible for orchestrating the January 6, 2021, attack on the Capitol. He has also dismissed allegations that Russia manipulated the 2016 election, saying that such accusations were part of the "Russia hoax." Kent was also accused of pressuring analysts to change their findings on a Venezuelan prison gang to align with the Trump administration's views.

It is also pertinent to state, as observed in the U.S. print media, that there are other senior administration officials who, like Kent, are sceptical of long overseas military engagements and often argue for a more restrained foreign policy, including Gabbard and Vice President JD Vance. However, the anti-interventionist wing has had a more muted influence on the Trump administration. It is also unlikely, as per some analyses, that Kent's exit will lead to a wave of further resignations. Gabbard and Vance have taken care not to let themselves drift too far out of step with President Trump. It is also worth mentioning that Kent is not the first official to resign from the administration over the war. A lower-level Trump administration appointee, Sameerah Munshi, announced last week that she was stepping down from the White House Religious Liberty Commission, citing the war with Iran as a major factor.

Continuing with the fallout of the war, it is evident that within 24 hours of the first strikes on Iran, a man wearing a shirt with the colours of the Iranian flag killed three people and injured more



Public opinion in the United States has steadily shifted against prolonged overseas military engagements since the early 2000s

than a dozen others at a bar in Austin, Texas, as confirmed by authorities. A week later, two teenagers from Pennsylvania, who claimed to be inspired by the Islamic State (IS), attempted to detonate an explosive device at a protest in New York, as stated by prosecutors. On March 12, a former National Guard member, who had spent many years in prison for supporting terrorism, walked into a classroom in Norfolk, Virginia, killing the instructor and wounding two students, according to the F.B.I. Less than two hours later, a man in Michigan ploughed a car into a synagogue and killed himself during a gunfight with security guards, police disclosed.

Since the beginning of the war, which took many Americans by surprise, police have stepped up patrols on public transit and around synagogues. Law enforcement officials are urging people to report any suspicious activity, much like the measures taken after the September 11 attacks. While President Trump has tried to reassure Americans, asserting that his adminis-

tration has been monitoring Iranian "sleeper cells" in the United States, recent attacks underscore that the dangers are diffuse and that violent attackers often emerge unexpectedly, following a pattern of lone-wolf attacks. These measures indicate heightened alertness in response to potential reprisals.

Meanwhile, the Israeli military claimed on March 15 that the brother of the man who drove a truck into a synagogue in Michigan on March 12 was a Hezbollah commander who had been killed in an Israeli airstrike in Lebanon earlier that month. The synagogue attacker, Ayman Mohamad Ghazali, was a naturalised U.S. citizen born in Lebanon. Four of his relatives were killed in an Israeli airstrike on March 5; his brother Ibrahim and his two children, as well as another brother, Qassem, according to a Lebanese official and a Muslim leader in Michigan. Israel stated that it had confirmed Ibrahim Mohamad Ghazali's role in Hezbollah after intelligence analysis, though it provided no further details on how the information was verified. These linkages suggest that such networks remain active and capable of signalling defiance and possible retaliation.

Now, the resignation of Kent and the war-related violence, including attacks targeting synagogues, point to a worrying trajectory. At this point, these developments may be confined to the United States; however, they could potentially extend across America and beyond as the war intensifies and its effects are felt elsewhere. Not only violent assaults, but also religious extremists may find this an opportune moment to exploit tensions, further polarising and radicalising vulnerable societies.

Views expressed are personal

RED TO
RADIANT



JAYANT NAHATA

THE WRITER
IS SERVING IN
DANTEWADA AS
THE CEO OF THE
ZILLA PANCHAYAT

From shuttered schools to science labs and coding campuses, Dantewada's shift highlights how governance can translate security gains into tangible human development

Dantewada's Quiet Revolution

Once defined by Maoist violence, Dantewada now offers a compelling model of how security, governance and sustained development can reshape even the most fragile regions

In the 2025 board examinations, Dantewada — a district in southern Chhattisgarh that spent decades on the front page for Maoist violence — topped the state in Class 10 results and ranked sixth in Class 12. Prime Minister Modi cited its achievements in back-to-back episodes of Mann Ki Baat in 2025. In March 2025, a TEDx event was held here, almost certainly the first in rural Bastar. None of this was imaginable a decade ago. The question worth asking is not merely what changed, but how.

For years, Dantewada was virtually synonymous with catastrophe, with frequent reports of encounters and ambushes. It was here that the deadliest Maoist ambush in Indian history killed 76 CRPF jawans in a single morning. In the ensuing atmosphere of fear and insecurity, field officials could not enter many villages. Schools, health centres and anganwadis in interior villages stayed shut. Development demanded peace first. The security efforts of the police and armed forces over the past several years have borne fruit: over 900 Maoists have surrendered, and many have been neutralised in the past two years alone. The Ministry of Home Affairs has since reclassified the district out of its 'most affected' LWE category. The space that security created, development has been quick to fill. Many successful developmental initiatives over the years have played a major role in not just lifting the district out of the shadow of its Naxal legacy, but also positioning it as a model that inspires change elsewhere.

The education story is where the district shines. A decade ago, illiteracy rates in Dantewada were above 50 per cent, with children pulled out of school by poverty, fear, or simply a lack of infrastructure. Rebuilding that trust, classroom by classroom, took years of effort. Thanks to initiatives like Choo Lo Aasmaan and Laqshya, which provide residential coaching facilities, tribal students



Dantewada's story is less about sudden success and more about how governance, when sustained, can rebuild trust in the state

from the district are increasingly cracking NIT, NEET and NDA examinations. "Education City" in Dantewada is being complemented by a 'Sports City' nearing completion, together forming an institutional anchor few thought viable in this geography. Bal Mitra Libraries — dedicated children's reading spaces, each with a trained community fellow — have opened in all 169 gram panchayats, making Dantewada the first district in India to do so.

Keeping pace with the times, the district, in partnership with the NavGurukul Foundation, is running a residential coding campus that has placed hundreds of students from tribal hinterlands in tech jobs over the past two years, in cities like Bengaluru and Hyderabad. On Saturdays, across the 800-plus schools, AI voice assistants take questions from students in Hindi and their native languages, building curiosity among children. At the District Science Centre — praised by PM Modi in Mann Ki Baat — children from the interiors of Bastar now explore 3D printing, robotics, virtual reality and astronomy.

Governance innovation has run alongside the education push, often against significant logistical odds. The district has completed the mam-

moth task of digitising and securing all of its 7 lakh-plus land records on a blockchain — many handwritten in crumbling ledgers dating back to the 1950s — in an effort that has eased access to land records for citizens. This model, now under replication, won the Chief Minister's Award for Digital Governance, 2026. Partnerships with IIT Madras and IIT Bhubaneswar on project implementation have improved delivery outcomes across sectors.

The human texture of the change is vivid across several fronts. Under PMAY, over 4,000 houses have been built in the past year, 306 of them sanctioned for surrendered Naxalites and conflict-affected families. Since July 2024, over 30,000 children, pregnant women and lactating mothers have received a daily egg through 1,067 anganwadi centres under the Universal Egg Programme, already showing a rapid drop in SAM and MAM cases. To boost specialised healthcare availability, a Rs 366 crore government medical college — unheard of in South Bastar — was sanctioned in 2025, and work has begun.

In agriculture, over 65,000 hectares across 110 villages have received the coveted Large Area Certification (LAC) — the largest organi-

cally certified agricultural region in India, surpassing the size of Sikkim. The produce sells under the 'Aadim' brand to other districts and states, with demand rising significantly. Recently, a Rs 25 crore Integrated Cold Chain and Multi-Product Food Irradiation Facility has been sanctioned under MoFPI's PMKSY scheme, along with DMF convergence, which holds the potential to boost exports of local agri and forest produce, generating substantial livelihood opportunities.

In sport, thousands of youth have participated in successive editions of the Bastar Olympics, an initiative of the state government to connect Bastar's youth with sports. Tribal girls and boys from the district's Thai boxing programme have bagged multiple gold medals at national and international championships.

Given the rapid improvement in security and infrastructure, tourism too is seeing a significant uptick. The 11th-century Dholkal Ganesh, a 3,000-foot trek into the Bailadila range, is drawing trekkers; homestays have multiplied near the white sands of Muchnar along the Indravati; Kumharas Lake near the district headquarters has emerged as a tourist hotspot for weekends. A 'Tent City', along with many premium cottages and an adventure park, is coming up at tourist sites to complete a planned tourist circuit linking them with the revered Danteshwari Mandir and the nearby Jagdalpur airport.

None of it was easy: the security environment improved because of the efforts of the police and armed personnel, alongside painstaking developmental work by the state. Poverty is real; seasonal out-migration continues. Groundwater iron contamination remains to be resolved, and so does the work on malnutrition. The weight of decades does not lift quickly. Dantewada is a story in progress. But the district, and the larger Bastar region, now have both momentum and direction.

Views expressed are personal

IBC HAS BEEN AMENDED SEVEN TIMES SO FAR

LS clears IBC (Amendment) Bill, 2025 with out-of-court settlement option

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Lok Sabha on Monday passed a bill to amend the insolvency law to provide for strict timelines, an out-of-court settlement option and enable the framework for cross-border insolvency processes.

Piloting the bill in the Lok Sabha, Finance and Corporate Affairs Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said that 12 amendments are being made in the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), which came into force in 2016, that would help maximise the value for stakeholders and improve the governing process itself.

Amendments seek to strengthen the existing insolvency framework, as well as address practical challenges, and incorporate evolving global best practices, the minister said, and added that the law has been a major factor in improving the health of the country's banking sector.

The Lower House cleared the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (Amendment) Bill, 2025, as reported by the Select Committee.

On August 12, 2025, the government introduced the bill in the Lok Sabha to amend the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), proposing a raft of changes, including provisions to reduce the time taken for



Amendments seek to strengthen the existing insolvency framework, as well as address practical challenges, and incorporate evolving global best practices, the Finance and Corporate Affairs Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said

admission of insolvency resolution applications.

The bill was referred to a select committee of the Lok Sabha, which submitted its report in December 2025.

Sitharaman stated that all the committee's recommendations have been accepted.

IBC has been amended seven times so far.

The bill replaces the under-utilised fast-track process with a new creditor-initiated insolvency framework, featuring out-of-court initiation, debtor-in-possession and creditor-in-control model, where management continues to vest

in the existing Board of Directors or partners with safeguards, and defined timelines.

Also, there is an enabling framework for group insolvency and cross-border insolvency to promote investor confidence and align domestic practices with best international practices, Sitharaman said.

Stricter timelines will be put in place to ensure the timely resolution of stressed companies, and there will be penalties to deter vexatious and frivolous complaints that delay the process.

Among other changes, an application for initiating the

Highlights

- » Sitharaman said that 12 amendments are being made in the IBC, that would help maximise the value for stakeholders and improve the governing process itself
- » There is an enabling framework for group insolvency, cross-border insolvency to promote investor confidence
- » Stricter timelines will be put in place to ensure the timely resolution of stressed firms, and there will be penalties

insolvency resolution process has to be admitted within 14 days if the default by a company has been established, and appeals related to IBC before the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal (NCLAT) have to be decided upon within three months.

Sitharaman said the primary cause of delay is extensive litigation and that various steps are being proposed in the bill to address the issue, including new provisions for penalties ranging from Rs 1 lakh to up to Rs 2 crore on persons initiating frivolous proceedings to prevent abuse and delays.

The Adjudicating Authority (AA) has to approve or reject a resolution plan within 30 days of receipt, and there will also be the creditor-initiated resolution process, which is a new out-of-court initiation mechanism with a compressed 150-day timeline, the minister said.

Responding to concerns related to the efficiency of the IBC framework, Sitharaman asserted that companies have been doing well post-resolution and cited a study to mention that the market capitalisation of such firms grew from Rs 2.8 lakh crore to Rs 9 lakh crore in five years after resolution.

Noting that the IBC is a major and very crucial factor in improving the health of the country's banking sector, the minister said Scheduled Commercial Banks (SCBs) have recovered a total of Rs 1,04,099 crore through various channels and out of the total amount, the IBC channel alone contributed a significant Rs 54,528 crore, accounting for 52.3 per cent of the total recoveries.

She also stressed that workmen's dues are not ignored under IBC and that such dues are given higher priority and are equivalent to secured creditors.

"It (workmen dues) is above the unsecured financial creditors and even government dues. This proves that the IBC regime wants to ensure workmen are not shortchanged," she said.

Markets slump over 2% on West Asia crisis, end FY26 with losses

Mcaps of BSE-listed cos tumbled Rs 18,60,662.29 crore to Rs 4,12,41,172.45 crore in two days of sharp decline

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Equity benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended the last trading session of the 2025-26 fiscal year sharply lower on Monday as the ongoing war in West Asia and surging crude oil prices kept investors' sentiment fragile.

Weak trends in Asian markets and unabated foreign fund outflows also added to the bearish trend in domestic equities.

Declining for the second day in a row, the 30-share BSE Sensex tumbled 1,635.67 points or 2.22 per cent to settle at 71,947.55. During the day, it plunged 1,809.09 points or 2.45 per cent to 71,774.13.

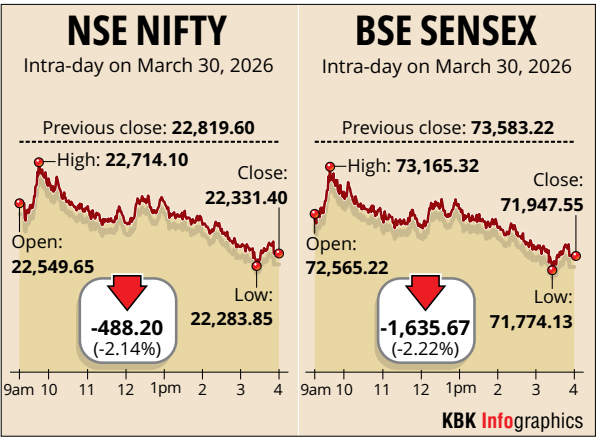
A total of 3,563 stocks declined, while 876 advanced and 154 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The 50-share NSE Nifty slumped 488.20 points or 2.14 per cent to end at 22,331.40.

The market capitalisation (mcaps) of BSE-listed companies tumbled Rs 18,60,662.29 crore to Rs 4,12,41,172.45 crore (\$4.36 trillion) in two days of sharp decline.

From the 30-Sensex firms, Bajaj Finance, State Bank of India, InterGlobe Aviation, Bajaj Finserv, Axis Bank and Kotak Mahindra Bank were among the biggest laggards.

On the other hand, Tech Mahindra and Power Grid



A total of 3,563 stocks declined, 876 advanced & 154 remained unchanged on the BSE

were the gainers.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 2.18 per cent to \$115.1 per barrel.

In the last two trading sessions, the BSE benchmark Sensex has lost 3,325.9 points, or 4.41 per cent, and the Nifty dived 975.05 points, or 4.18 per cent.

In the 2025-26 financial year, the BSE benchmark plunged 5,467.37 points, or 7 per cent, and the Nifty dropped 1,187.95 points, or 5 per cent.

The BSE MidCap Select index lost 3.13 per cent, and the SmallCap Select index declined 2.14 per cent.

Sectorally, all indices ended in the red, with auto, FMCG, consumer durables, capital goods, realty, private banks, and PSU banks falling in the range of 2-4 per cent.

The BSE PSU Bank tanked 4.60 per cent, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt (3.96 per cent), Bankex (3.80 per cent), Financial Services (3.46 per cent), Private Banks (3.43 per cent), BSE Top 10 Banks (3.40 per cent), Telecom (3.09 per cent) & Realty (3.03 per cent).

FIIIs offloaded equities worth Rs 4,367.30 crore on Friday, according to exchange data. Domestic Institutional Investors, however, bought stocks worth Rs 3,566.15 crore.

Economic fundamentals strong, rupee doing 'absolutely fine': FM

NEW DELHI: Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Monday said the country's economic fundamentals are strong, and compared to other emerging market economies, the Indian rupee is "absolutely going fine" against the US dollar.

Since the commencement of the West Asia conflict on February 28, 2026, the rupee has depreciated by 4.1 per cent to close at Rs 94.82 per USD on March 27, 2026.

Replying to a supplementary question in the Lok Sabha on rupee depreciation, Sitharaman said: "India's economy is strong, our fiscal situation is strong, and the entire world is praising our fiscal deficit management. Our forex reserves are solid."

"Compared to other emerging economies, the rupee is doing fine (theek chal raha



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

hai)...Absolutely going fine."

In a written reply, Sitharaman said the rupee depreciation is not specific to INR, as since the beginning of the West Asia conflict, major Asian currencies have also depreciated.

Certain peers, such as the South Korean Won, Thai Baht and Philippine Peso, have declined against the USD more than the rupee, by 4.6 per cent, 5.5 per cent and 4.8 per cent,

respectively, she said.

Replying to the question, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said that the value of the rupee is market-determined and is influenced by various factors.

"The government and the RBI are keeping a close watch on the value of the rupee," he said.

Chaudhary said inflation in India has eased, with the average retail inflation declining from 6.2 per cent in 2020-21 to 4.6 per cent in 2024-25 and further to 1.9 per cent in 2025-26 (April-February).

Prices of most essential commodities have remained stable or exhibited a decreasing trend, he said.

The rupee (INR) depreciated 9.9 per cent against the US Dollar (USD) in the current fiscal (till March 27, 2026).

LIC offices to remain open on March 31 for policyholders

NEW DELHI: Life Insurance Corporation (LIC) of India offices across zones and divisions will remain open on March 30 and 31 during normal working hours to ensure uninterrupted services for policyholders. The decision follows an advisory issued by the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) on March 28.

The move is aimed at preventing any inconvenience to customers during the financial year-end, when transaction volumes typically rise.

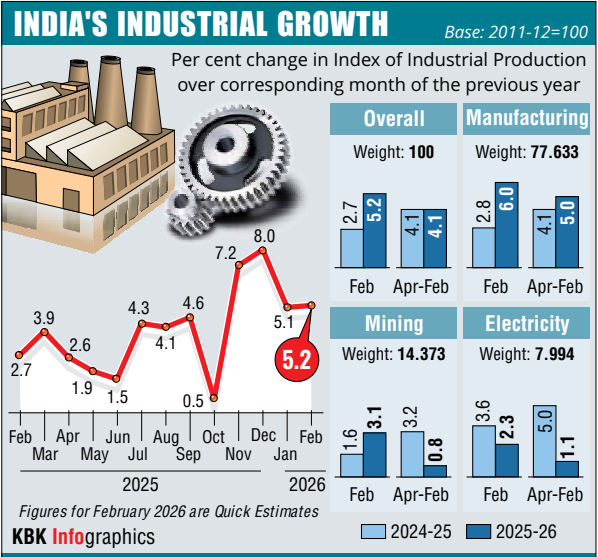
Policyholders will be able to access services, including premium payments and policy-related requests, without disruption at LIC branches during these dates.

NEW DELHI: India's industrial production grew 5.2 per cent in February, mainly due to an improvement in manufacturing output, according to official data released on Monday. The factory output, measured in terms of the Index of Industrial Production (IIP), expanded by 2.7 per cent in February 2025, an official statement said.

The National Statistics Office (NSO) revised the industrial production growth for January 2026 to 5.1 per cent from the provisional estimate of 4.8 per cent released earlier this month. NSO data further showed that the manufacturing sector's output growth accelerated to 6 per cent in February 2026 compared to 2.8 per cent in the year-ago month.

Mining production growth slightly improved to 3.1 per cent compared to 1.6 per cent recorded a year ago.

Power generation growth



stood at 2.3 per cent in February compared to 3.6 per cent expansion in the year-ago period.

During the April-February period of FY26, the country's

industrial production growth remained flat year-on-year at 4.1 per cent. Within the manufacturing sector, 14 out of 23 industry groups have recorded

a positive growth in February 2026 compared to a year ago.

The top three positive contributors for February 2026 are Manufacture of basic metals (13.2 per cent), Manufacture of motor vehicles, trailers and semi-trailers (14.9 per cent) and Manufacture of machinery and equipment (10.2 per cent).

The corresponding growth rates of IIP, as per use-based classification in February 2026 over February 2025, are 1.8 per cent in Primary goods, 12.5 per cent in Capital goods, 7.7 per cent in Intermediate goods, 11.2 per cent in Infrastructure/Construction Goods, 7.3 per cent in Consumer durables and (-) 0.6 per cent in Consumer non-durables.

In the industry group 'Manufacture of basic metals', item groups 'MS slabs', 'Flat products of Alloy Steel' and 'Pipes & tubes of Steel' have shown significant contribution to growth.

RBI injects ₹84,582 cr in banking system in two VRR auctions

MUMBAI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) on Monday injected Rs 84,582 crore of transient liquidity into the banking system via two variable rate repo (VRR) auctions.

The central bank injected Rs 50,001 crore through first three-day VRR auction early in the day at cut-off rate of 5.34 per cent and weighted average rate of 5.44 per cent, the central bank said in a release.

The Reserve Bank injected another Rs 34,581 crore at 5.26 per cent cut-off and 5.30 per cent weighted average rate at an auction later during the day.

In the first auction, the central bank received bids of Rs 57,287 crore as against the notified amount of Rs 50,000 crore and accepted bids worth Rs 50,001 crore. However, for the second auction, bids received were lower than the notified amount.

Currently, liquidity in the banking system is estimated to be in surplus of about Rs 1.27 lakh crore as on March 27.

In the last few days, the central bank infused transient liquidity of Rs 2,73,530 crore in to the banking system through VRR auctions of various tenures.

Tech can bring scientific credibility to India's traditional healthcare systems: AYUSH Minister

NEW DELHI: India's push towards a preventive and holistic healthcare model took centre stage at a national summit, with policymakers and experts stressing the integration of traditional knowledge and modern technology.

Addressing the 4th Annual Summit on "Advancing Holistic Health through Innovation, Technology, and Tradition", organised by the Illness to Wellness Foundation, Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for AYUSH, Prataprao Jadhav said digitalisation can help bring scientific credibility to India's traditional healthcare systems like Ayurveda, Yoga, Unani, Siddha and Homeopathy.

The minister highlighted growing burden of lifestyle diseases & underscored that healthcare must extend beyond hospitals to everyday living

He highlighted the growing burden of lifestyle diseases and underscored that healthcare must extend beyond hospitals to everyday living and preventive practices.

The summit brought

together healthcare professionals, industry leaders and academicians, who emphasised the need to shift from a treatment-led approach to preventive care.

Discussions focused on leveraging digital tools such as telemedicine, AI-driven diagnostics and data-based interventions to improve access and enable early detection, especially in underserved regions.

Anil Rajput, Chairperson, Advisory Council, Illness to Wellness Foundation, said, "Integrating traditional medicine with emerging technologies is essential to create scalable, evidence-based healthcare systems while also driving behavioural change at the grassroots level."

Mental health emerged as a key theme, with experts calling for stronger awareness and institutional support to address stress, burnout and emotional well-being in workplaces and schools.

Panellists also highlighted the importance of lifestyle interventions such as yoga, meditation and nutrition in mainstream healthcare, positioning them as critical tools for long-term disease prevention.

The summit further showcased outreach initiatives engaging students across Delhi-NCR on health, hygiene and environmental awareness, reflecting efforts to embed wellness practices early in life.

THE SALES HAVE FALLEN BELOW 1 LAKH UNITS MARK AFTER 18 QUARTERS

Housing sales in top 9 cities dip 13% in Jan-March qtr: PropEquity

NEW DELHI: Housing sales across nine major cities fell 13 per cent annually during January-March quarter to 98,761 units on lower fresh supply of inventories amid West Asia conflict, according to PropEquity. The real estate research firm on Monday pointed out that the sales have fallen below 1 lakh units mark after 18 quarters. The nine major cities are Delhi-NCR, Mumbai, Navi Mumbai, Thane, Bengaluru, Pune, Hyderabad, Chennai and Kolkata.

As per the data, housing sales fell 13 per cent to 98,761 units during January-March this year compared to 1,13,602 units in the year-ago period.

The total sales in these nine cities declined 6 per cent from 1,05,527 units in the previous quarter (Oct-Dec 2025).

Samir Jasuja, Founder & CEO of PropEquity said, "Housing sales continued to moderate in the first quarter of 2026 with Delhi-NCR and Bengaluru emerging as outliers. This reduction is on account of low supply across most cities. Close to 22,000 lesser units were supplied in Q1 2026 as compared to the same period last year."

New supply fell 19 per cent to 92,411 units during January-March period from 1,14,718 units in the corresponding period last year. The launches

Closer Look

- » Housing sales fell to 98,761 units during January-March this year against 1,13,602 units in the year-ago period
- » The total sales in these nine cities declined 6 per cent from 1,05,527 units in previous quarter (Oct-Dec 2025)
- » New supply fell 19% to 92,411 units in January-March period from 1,14,718 units in same period last year

dipped 8 per cent from the preceding quarter which saw new supply of 1,00,525 units.

Although PropEquity has not mentioned the reason for fall in launches this quarter, industry experts said the ongoing West Asia conflict has affected buying sentiment

According to the PropEquity data, housing sales in Bengaluru rose 3 per cent to 17,991 units during January-March 2026 from 17,508 units in the year-ago period.

In Delhi-NCR, housing sales increased 13 per cent to 12,141 units from 10,723 units. How-

ever, housing sales in Chennai fell 4 per cent to 4,765 units from 4,959 units. Hyderabad saw a 16 per cent decline in sales to 11,546 units from 13,725 units.

Sales of residential properties in Mumbai fell 20 per cent to 9,186 units from 11,453 units. Navi Mumbai witnessed a 14 per cent fall to 7,157 units from 8,340 units, while Thane saw a 24 per cent decline to 15,959 units from 21,025 units. In Pune, the sales fell 25 per cent to 16,144 units from 21,640 units.

Lastly, the housing sales in Kolkata declined 8 per cent to 3,872 units during January-March period from 4,229 units

in the year-ago period.

On the sales data, Bhavesh Kothari, Founder & CEO of Property First Realty, said Bengaluru's dominance as the highest-selling housing market underscores the city's strong fundamentals driven by its thriving tech ecosystem, steady job creation, and sustained demand from both end-users and investors. Bengaluru-based Sanjeevini Group Chairman and Founder Umesh Gowda H A said the steady rise in supply in the IT city remains well-aligned with the demand, reflecting developers' prudent and market-responsive pricing strategies.

Black Box raises ₹386 cr via warrant conversion

NEW DELHI: Digital infrastructure solutions provider Black Box, an Essar Group firm, on Monday said it has raised Rs 386.36 crore through the conversion of warrants into equity shares, with promoters contributing Rs 200 crore to the total infusion.

The company converted over 92.65 lakh warrants at an issue price of Rs 417 per share, according to a regulatory filing.

"Black Box Limited... today announced the successful receipt of Rs 386.36 crore pursuant to the conversion of warrants issued on September 27, 2024... All warrant holders have exercised their rights in full, with no forfeiture or withdrawal."

"Promoters participated meaningfully in the issue, contributing Rs 200 crore, representing 51.76 per cent of the total infusion," the filing said.

Following the conversion, the promoter shareholding in the company has increased to 69.99 per cent. Black Box CEO Sanjeev Verma said the capital infusion strengthens the company's balance sheet and provides flexibility to accelerate its growth agenda, scale digital infrastructure capabilities, and expand its market presence.

WTO meet ends without consensus on e-commerce duty moratorium

The existing moratoriums related to electronic transmissions and TRIPS non-violation are scheduled to expire on March 31

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The World Trade Organization's fourteenth Ministerial Conference (MC14) concluded on Monday in Yaounde, Cameroon with members failing to resolve the contentious issue of extending the moratorium on customs duties on electronic commerce, such as digital downloads and streaming.

In May 1998, WTO members agreed for the first time not to impose customs duties on electronic transmissions for two years, a moratorium that has been extended biennially since then. Its expiry would open the door to imposing tariffs on e-commerce.

Talks on the duty ban reached a deadlock between Brazil and the US. While some member countries opposed an extension or favour two years, the US was pushing for a longer duration of five years.

The existing moratoriums related to electronic transmissions and TRIPS non-violation are scheduled to expire on March 31. The 14th Ministerial Conference (MC14) of the World Trade Organization (WTO) began on March 26 in the capital city of Cameroon. Though the talks were sched-



The WTO said ministers agreed to continue engaging in negotiations on fisheries subsidies, aiming to make recommendations to the 15th Ministerial Conference

uled to end on March 29, they were slightly extended and concluded on March 30.

Cameroon's Minister of Trade Luc Magloire Mbarga Atangana, the Chair of MC14, said that trade ministers worked to conclude as many issues as possible across various areas of negotiation during the four-day meeting.

However, he said "we ran out of time" with regard to several outstanding issues, such as

Highlights

» WTO work programme defines e-commerce as production, distribution, marketing, sale or delivery of goods and services by electronic means

» Since 1998, the WTO members have agreed not to impose tariffs on electronic transmissions

» However, on multiple occasions, developing nations have opposed the extension as they are witnessing a rise in the imports of electronic transmissions

the WTO's work programme on electronic commerce and the continuation of the existing moratoriums on customs duties for electronic transmissions and non-violation complaints under the Agreement on Trade-related Aspects of Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS).

It was agreed to continue the talks on these issues in Geneva, the World Trade Organisation (WTO) headquarters.

Director-General Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala welcomed the progress in discussions on a work programme for advancing ongoing talks on WTO reform, the decision on advancing work on further disciplines on harmful fisheries subsidies, and other issues.

She suggested members use the draft texts developed over the four days of ministerial discussions to finalize agreements on outstanding issues in Geneva at the next General Council meeting.

The WTO, in a statement, said ministers agreed to continue engaging in negotiations on fisheries subsidies, aiming to make recommendations to the 15th Ministerial Conference.

The Ministerial Conference, held every two years, is the highest decision-making body of the WTO. Nearly 2,000 trade officials, including more than 90 ministers, attended the MC14. It was only the second time the MC was held in Africa. The MC10 was held in Nairobi in 2015.

ECOMMERCE MORATORIUM:

WTO's work programme defines e-commerce as the production, distribution, marketing, sale or delivery of goods and services by electronic

means.

Products that were always traded physically are now increasingly traded digitally, with streaming services progressively taking the place of CDs or DVDs and with e-books witnessing growing demand.

Customs duties are usually applied by WTO members on imported goods, but since 1998, they have agreed not to impose tariffs on electronic transmissions.

WTO members have agreed not to impose customs duties on electronic transmissions such as digital downloads and streaming since 1998.

However, on multiple occasions, developing nations have opposed the extension as they are witnessing a rise in the imports of electronic transmissions, mainly items like movies, music, video games and printed matter, some of which could fall within the scope of the moratorium.

Think tank GTRI said the US, supported by the EU and Japan, pushed for a long-term or permanent extension, while India and other developing countries opposed this, arguing it would lock in revenue losses and limit policy space in a rapidly growing digital economy.

OALP: India to offer 21 oil, gas blocks in 11th bidding round

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India is likely to offer 21 blocks for prospecting of oil and natural gas in the next bidding round under Open Acreage Licensing Policy (OALP), according to the Directorate General of Hydrocarbons (DGH).

DGH on its website put out a list of the 21 blocks, made up of 12 onland areas, four shallow water blocks, one deepsea block and four ultra-deep sea blocks, that will be offered in the 11th round of OALP (OALP-XI).

The area to be offered for bidding is about 80,235 square kilometers.

"Bid submission start and closing dates (will) be announced soon," DGH said.

DGH unveiled the blocks and bidding parameters for OALP-XI round even as bids for the previous OALP-X round are yet to come in.

According to the DGH, bidders offering the highest revenue share, plus quoting the most work programme, would be awarded the 14 blocks in Category-I sedimentary basins on offer in OALP-XI.

For the second, Category-II & III blocks, bidders quoting the highest work programme of doing seismic and drilling well will get the blocks.

Category-I sedimentary basin is one with proven commercial production of oil and gas. Category-II are ones with confirmed hydrocarbon accumulation but not yet been developed for commercial pro-



DGH on its website put out a list of the 21 blocks, made up of 12 onland areas, four shallow water blocks, one deepsea block and four ultra-deep sea blocks

duction while Category-III are ones with considered geologically prospective but no commercial discoveries have been made to date.

OALP-X round, which was launched in February 2025 during India Energy Week (IEW) 2025 in New Delhi, was originally scheduled to close at the end of July that year. In late July, the deadline was extended to October 31 and again to December 31, 2025. The deadline was then extended till February 18, 2026 and now it is due on May 29.

OALP-X is the largest oil and gas acreage offering ever, with 25 blocks on offer cover a total of about 191,986 sq km. The acreage on offer comprises

six onshore blocks, six shallow-water tracts, one deepwater block and 12 located in ultra-deepwater across 13 sedimentary basins, according to the DGH.

The round offers the largest area so far for exploration and production of crude oil, which is refined into fuels like petrol and diesel, and natural gas, which is used to produce power, make urea, turned into CNG to run automobiles and fire household kitchens.

In the previous nine rounds, 3.78 lakh sq km area was offered. The previous bid round, OALP-IX, was the largest before OALP-X round. The OALP-IX bid round featured 28 blocks or areas spread over 1.36 lakh sq km were offered for finding and producing oil and gas.

OALP bid rounds were introduced after an open acreage policy was brought in 2016, which moved away from the previous practice of the government identifying and bidding out blocks to one where explorers were allowed the freedom to identify any area outside of the ones that are already with some company or other, for prospecting of oil and gas.

The salient features of this policy, called Hydrocarbon Exploration and Licensing Policy (HELP), include reduced royalty rates and concessional royalty rates for early commercial production, no oil CESS, exploration rights on all retained areas over the full contract life, and marketing and pricing freedom.

DGCA & GSV join hands to boost aviation training

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: In a big move for India's civil aviation sector, the country's flight watchdog DGCA teamed up with Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya (GSV) with an objective of sharing/enhancing of knowledge, skills relevant to the scientific, technological, and management aspects in the broad areas of Aviation, Aviation Engineering and Aviation Management.

The agreement between them wasn't loud – just firm, clear, and written down. One signature came from Faiz Ahmed Kidwai, acting for DGCA. The other pen belonged to Manoj Choudhury, head of Gati Shakti Vishwavidyalaya.

Both marks were made while Minister of Civil Aviation K Rammohan Naidu – and Minister of Railways Ashwini Vaishnaw looked on.

Starting in 2026–27, a new B.Sc. in Aviation Maintenance Engineering arrives through stronger ties between schools and industry.

This agreement focuses on building expertise in aviation engineering, oversight, and upkeep.

Instead of just theory, the curriculum blends classroom knowledge with real-world rules plus actual job demands.

One standout feature? It lasts three years, shaping practical readiness alongside formal study.

DVK foundation launches scholarship for EWS students at BGIS, Vrindavan

NEW DELHI: DVK Foundation has been established with the primary objective of supporting meritorious students from economically weaker sections (EWS) by providing them access to quality education and opportunities for academic and personal growth.

DVK foundation introduces a special scholarship for EWS students at Bhaktivedanta Gurukula and International School (BGIS), Vrindavan which is ranked no.1 Boarding school in the state of Uttar Pradesh. This initiative provides financial support, study materials, and awards to help bright students achieve academic excellence and build a brighter future. In this regard an MoU has been signed recently between DVK Foundation and BGIS.

Under this initiative,



selected students, known as DV Kapur Scholars, will receive support in the form of study materials, uniforms, laptops, and awards to help them excel academically. The foundation aims to encourage meritorious students and provide them with the resources needed for their educational growth.

The scholarship includes several benefits such as an Annual Merit Award of up to Rs 20,000 for selected students of

In this regard an MoU has been signed between DVK Foundation & Bhaktivedanta Gurukula and International School

Classes VIII, IX, and XI, based on school recommendation and foundation approval. This programme has been started from the academic session 2025–26 and will continue until the student graduates. The school will manage the funds responsibly and disburse them according to the agreed conditions. DVK foundation congratulates to all the selected students—aim high and make the most of this valuable opportunity.

Airport360 Expo 2026 focuses on aviation growth with govt support

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Spotlight falls on India's surging air travel industry at the upcoming Airport360 Expo 2026, set for April 23-24 at Mumbai's main exhibition hub. With authorities pushing hard to widen terminal space and modernise runways across regions, the timing hits a critical point.

Though growth has been steady, fresh momentum now drives upgrades in both big cities and smaller hubs. Behind closed doors, planners are aligning timelines while juggling budgets and environmental checks. Even remote airstrips see attention as connectivity becomes priority one. While travelers face delays today, long-term shifts aim to ease congestion by decade's end. Still unanswered - how



fast rules can adapt to match physical progress.

By 2030, passenger flights inside the country could hit 300 million, while plane numbers rise sharply before 2027 - fueling state-backed plans for faster economic expansion through flight networks. Over fifty fresh airports now rising show how serious these ambitions are. Put together by Media Fusion, the event gathers central players like carriers, terminal managers, and tech firms, linking their work to wider targets for

transport links and structural progress.

Flying into view, the gathering should draw above 2,200 people, made up of 50 display units along with guests from over 10 nations, underlining how India gains ground in aviation reach. Instead of just meetings, it puts forward fresh thinking around airport set-ups, upkeep efforts, greener methods, and digital layers - sections tied deeply to official plans aiming at upgrading transit routes while improving traveler comfort.

Airport displays mirror efforts aimed at growing flight infrastructure, linking remote areas better, while helping India become central point for cargo movement. What stands out is how growth targets tie into stronger transport networks across regions.

ONGC begins gas output from its Daman project

NEW DELHI: State-owned Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) has commenced gas production from its Daman Upside Development Project in the Arabian Sea, strengthening India's domestic energy supply amid global disruptions.

In a regulatory filing, the firm said the project, located about 180 kms north-west of Mumbai and about 80 kms south of Pipavav, Gujarat, "achieved a significant milestone on March 29 by monetisation through flowing gas from Platform B-12-24P".

"This platform has been successfully commissioned and gas sent to Hazira Plant," it said, adding that the project was executed in less than two years

from the date of award. The project aims to produce 21.5 billion cubic meters of gas, utilising 4 new wellhead platforms (including B-12-24P) and 140 km of pipelines to send gas to the Hazira plant.

It is expected to reach a peak production of around 5 million standard cubic meters per day.

ONGC, however, did not give current flow rates. "This (commissioning) has been achieved through strong project execution, innovative use of the drill-deck and strong performance by drilling and production teams. This milestone marks the commencement of gas monetisation from the DUDP (Daman Upside Development Project)," it said.

Disbursement under ECMS will stop if design, and Six Sigma quality not met, says Vaishnaw

NEW DELHI: Electronics and IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Monday issued an ultimatum to electronics component industry to act swiftly on the Centre's key asks for a concrete plan on building design capabilities, achieving Six Sigma quality standards, and enhancing workforce skilling — or else risk losing out on disbursements and new approvals under the Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme (ECMS).

After granting approvals to 29 proposals under ECMS entailing fresh investment of Rs 7,104 crore, Vaishnaw cautioned that beneficiaries who do not invest in product design could be weeded out. "I am willing

to stop any further disbursements or approvals if the industry doesn't come up with the commensurate efforts," he said.

The minister pulled up industry body ICEA (India Cellular and Electronics Association) for not adhering to the integrated approach set by MeitY to boost high quality and self-reliant electronics manufacturing. "I request the industry whichever way you are organised... be it ICEA, MAIT, any other association... to come out with a proper structured program. Because in the last meeting the industry had committed that by March-end they will have a proper structured program on all the four aspects

but I don't see it, so far," he said.

"So while we are trying our best, it is now... the ball is in the industry's court... to come up with equal efforts. The efforts that we are making as government, you have to be in tango & you have to scale up your efforts and ambitions on these aspects," he said. He warned that continued inaction — despite government asks — could result in weeding out of proposals.

"Over a period of time those who do not invest in design will be weeded out. We will make sure that they are weeded out. I am saying that very blunt and very open because that is very very important for our nation and we in our party, we always

believe nation first, always first," the minister said. Vaishnaw emphasised that the country needs to get into electronics, component & machine design.

The minister has given a 15-day deadline to the industry to update the government on steps taken by the players on four key asks — product design, Six Sigma standards, talent development and local sourcing. Six Sigma is a methodology aimed at minimising defects and ensuring near-perfect output. Delivering the ultimatum to the industry in a packed hall, Vaishnaw said all 75 applications approved to date under ECMS will have to share their plan within 15 days.

Fiscal deficit at 80.4% of FY26 target till Feb

The Centre estimates the fiscal deficit during 2025-26 at 4.4% of GDP

NEW DELHI: The central government's fiscal deficit stood at Rs 12.52 lakh crore at the end of February, or 80.4 per cent of the annual budget target for 2025-26 compared to 85.8 per cent in the year-ago period, according to government data released on Monday.

The Centre estimates the fiscal deficit (the gap between expenditure and revenue) during 2025-26 at 4.4 per cent of GDP, or Rs 15.58 lakh crore.

According to monthly accounts released by the Controller General of Accounts (CGA), the Centre's total receipts stood at Rs 27.91 lakh

CLOSER LOOK

» According to monthly accounts released by the CGA, the Centre's total receipts stood at Rs 27.91 lakh crore, or 82% of the budget target by February-end 2026

» The receipts included Rs 21.45 lakh crore tax revenue (net) and Rs 5.8 lakh crore non-tax revenue

» CGA data showed that the Centre's total expenditure during April-February FY26 stood at Rs 40.44 lakh crore, or 81.5% of the full financial year budget target

crore, or 82 per cent of the budget target by February-end 2026.

The receipts included Rs 21.45 lakh crore tax revenue (net) and Rs 5.8 lakh crore non-

tax revenue.

CGA said Rs 12.66 lakh crore was transferred to state governments as devolution of share of taxes by the Centre

during the period, which is Rs 85,837 crore higher than the previous year.

CGA data showed that the central government's total expenditure during April-February 2025-26 stood at Rs 40.44 lakh crore, or 81.5 per cent of the full financial year budget target.

Of the total expenditure, Rs 31.15 lakh crore was on revenue account and Rs 9.29 lakh crore was on capital account.

Out of the total revenue expenditure, Rs 10.65 lakh crore went towards interest payments and Rs 3.89 lakh crore towards major subsidies.

NEW DELHI: The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) should consider deploying its foreign exchange reserves to stabilise the rupee amid volatility triggered by the West Asia crisis, according to a research report by the State Bank of India (SBI) on Monday.

The rupee breached the 95 per dollar mark during intra-day trade before settling 7 paise higher at 94.78 against the US dollar, as escalating geopolitical tensions dampened global sentiment.

SBI's economic research department noted that India's forex reserves—exceeding \$700 billion and covering over 10 months of imports—remain robust. It said these reserves



are sufficient to counter speculative pressures and that intervention, if deemed necessary, should not be reserved only for extreme situations.

The report also recommended a special window for oil marketing companies (OMCs) to separate their daily forex demand of \$250–300 million from broader market activity. This, it said, would improve

It flagged concerns over RBI's recent move to cap banks' net open position at \$100 million, effective April 10

transparency in demand-supply dynamics and help assess the effectiveness of regulatory measures.

It flagged concerns over the RBI's recent move to cap banks' net open position (NOP-INR) at \$100 million, effective April 10, stating it may widen the gap between onshore and offshore markets. Indian banks are typically long in onshore markets

and short offshore, while foreign banks show the opposite trend.

As banks unwind positions, liquidity pressures could intensify, pushing offshore premiums higher. On Monday, one-year non-deliverable forward (NDF) premia rose to 4.19 per cent from 3.43 per cent, while one-month premia climbed to 0.67 per cent. Offshore rates were quoted at Rs 98.41.

The report suggested limiting the \$100 million cap to trading books rather than entire bank books to avoid operational challenges, especially as foreign investors may withdraw funds, increasing genuine forex demand.

CREATING A NEW INDIA

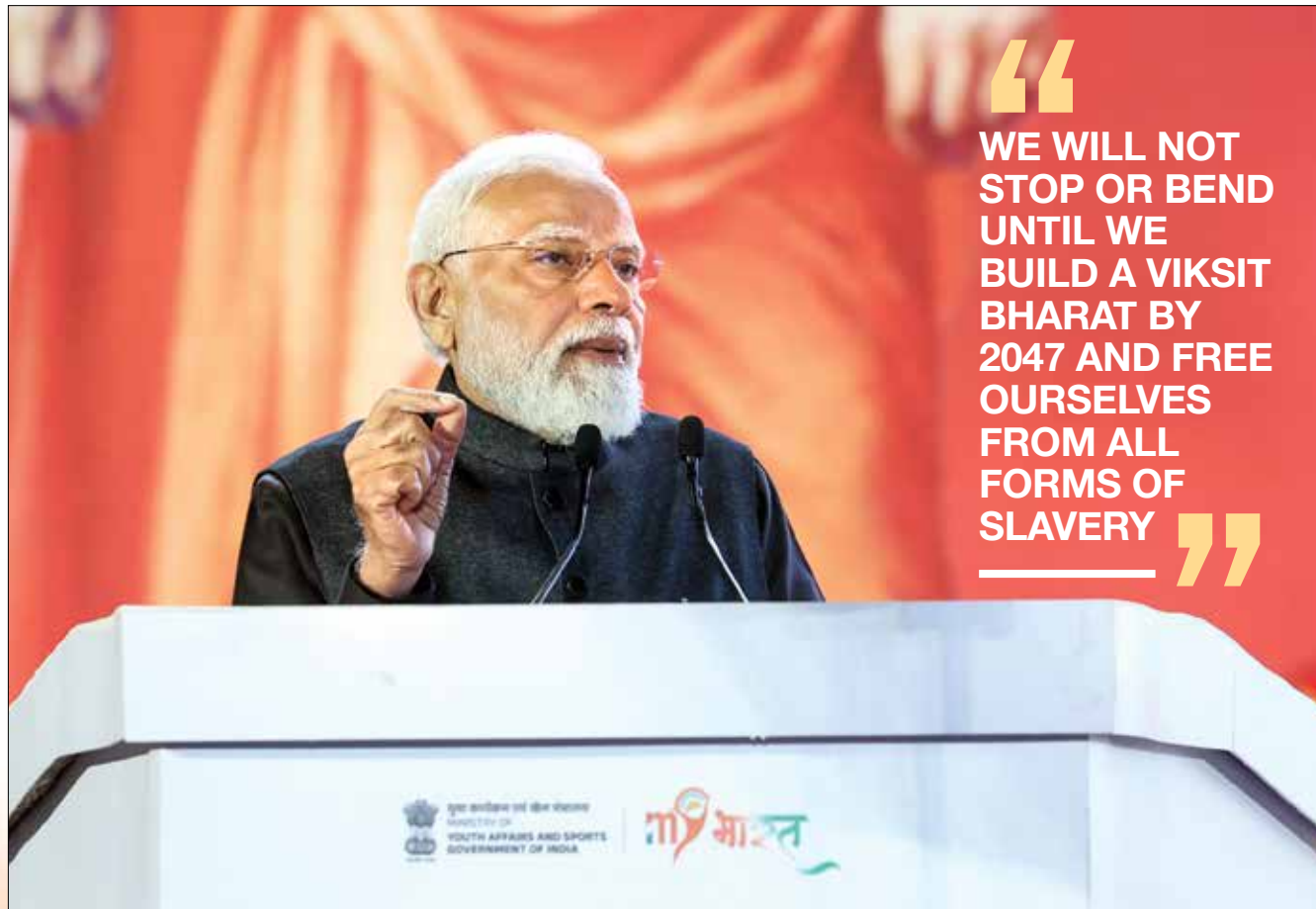
A decade of decisive governance, reform-driven growth, and technological transformation has positioned India as a confident, future-ready nation steadily advancing towards the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047

The past twelve years have come to define a decisive phase in India's journey—one where intent has increasingly aligned with execution. When Narendra Modi assumed office in 2014, the promise extended beyond routine governance. It was about reimagining India's trajectory across economic, social, technological and institutional dimensions. What has unfolded since is not a singular leap, but a steady, layered transformation that has sought to recalibrate the country's growth model. This period has coincided with some of the most turbulent global developments in recent history—from economic slowdowns and supply chain disruptions to the unprecedented shock of the COVID-19 pandemic. Yet, India's policy direction has

remained anchored in long-term structural change. The idea of a 'Viksit Bharat 2047'—a developed India by the centenary of independence—has emerged as both a roadmap and a rallying call. It is not framed as an abstract aspiration, but as a time-bound national commitment, requiring the convergence of governance, enterprise and citizen participation. The shift is also psychological. India today increasingly sees itself not as a developing economy seeking validation, but as a nation capable of setting benchmarks—be it in digital innovation, financial inclusion, or large-scale infrastructure development. This evolving confidence underpins much of the transformation witnessed over the past decade.

ECONOMIC MOMENTUM

At the core of India's rise lies a robust economic story. Over the past decade, the country has not only sustained growth but has also strengthened its position within the global economic hierarchy. India's GDP has more than doubled—from around \$2.1 trillion in 2015 to over \$4.3 trillion—placing it among the world's largest economies. The



momentum is further underscored by projections that position India as the fastest-growing major economy, with growth rates consistently above 6 per cent in the coming years. This resilience has been particularly notable in the face of global uncertainties, reinforcing India's image as a stable and reliable growth engine. The milestone of surpassing Japan

to emerge among the world's largest economies reflects more than numerical progress. It signals deeper structural changes—rising domestic consumption, expanding investment, and a growing integration with global trade systems. India's economic architecture has gradually shifted from being inward-looking to becoming more globally engaged,

while still retaining the strength of its domestic market, which accounts for nearly 70 per cent of GDP. Reforms have played a central role in this evolution. The implementation of the Goods and Services Tax (GST), emphasis on ease of doing business, and targeted incentives for manufacturing have collectively aimed at creating a more efficient

and competitive economic environment. The push towards 'Aatmanirbhar Bharat' has further reinforced the focus on self-reliance, without disengaging from global opportunities.

Financial markets have mirrored this confidence. India today hosts some of the world's largest stock exchanges by trading volume, reflecting both institutional depth and growing retail participation. The economic story, therefore, is not confined to macro indicators; it is increasingly embedded in the everyday financial engagement of citizens.

INFRASTRUCTURE TRANSFORMATION

If economic growth provides the foundation, infrastructure offers the visible evidence of transformation. Over the past decade, India has undertaken one of the most ambitious infrastructure expansion programmes in its history. The scale is striking: a road network exceeding 6.6 million kilometres, making it among the largest in the world, with rapid additions to expressways and high-capacity corridors.

The expansion of highways, logistics corridors, and dedicated freight routes has significantly improved connectivity, reducing travel time and enhancing efficiency across sectors. Flagship projects such as the Delhi-Mumbai Expressway and other multi-lane corridors are not merely engineering achievements; they are economic enablers that facilitate trade, mobility and regional integration.

Railways have witnessed modernisation efforts aimed

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at improving both speed and passenger experience, while the aviation sector has expanded its footprint, bringing air travel within reach of smaller cities. Ports and logistics infrastructure have also been strengthened, enabling India to handle a significant share of its trade more efficiently.

The impact of this infrastructure push extends beyond physical connectivity. It has created employment opportunities, supported industrial growth, and improved access to markets for farmers and small businesses. More importantly, it reflects a shift in governance—from incremental upgrades to large-scale, future-oriented planning.

DIGITAL INDIA REVOLUTION

Perhaps the most transformative shift of the past decade has been India's emergence as a global leader in digital public infrastructure. At the centre of this transformation is the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), which has redefined how financial transactions are conducted in the country.

UPI today accounts for nearly half of all global real-time digital transactions, making it the largest such system in the world. Its scale is staggering—processing billions of transactions each month, with record volumes such as 20.7 billion transactions in a single month.

EMPOWERING INDIA'S FARMERS

Much of the discourse around India's agricultural sector has, in recent years, been framed through the lens of protests and policy disagreements. While these moments have drawn attention, they often obscure the broader transformation underway—one that is steadily equipping Indian farmers to compete on a global stage. The government's approach has moved beyond short-term relief to building long-term resilience, productivity and market access. At the centre of this shift has been a multi-pronged strategy.

Income support through PM-KISAN has ensured direct financial assistance to millions of farmers, while initiatives such as the Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana have expanded crop insurance coverage, reducing vulnerability to climate risks. Investments in irrigation, soil health mapping and digital agriculture platforms are helping farmers make more informed decisions, improving both yield and efficiency. Equally significant is the push towards market reforms and infrastructure development—from strength-

ening mandis to enabling better storage and logistics networks. These efforts are gradually integrating Indian agriculture with wider value chains, opening opportunities beyond traditional boundaries. Under the leadership of Narendra Modi, the focus has been clear: to move Indian agriculture from subsistence to sustainability, and from local survival to global competitiveness. While debates will continue, the larger trajectory points towards a sector being prepared not just to endure, but to thrive.

exploration, Indian innovation is increasingly addressing both domestic challenges and global opportunities.

Space exploration stands out as a symbol of this ambition. India's achievements in this domain have not only demonstrated technical capability but have also reinforced its position as a serious player in high-technology sectors.

continues to guide policy and public discourse. It is a vision that encompasses economic strength, social inclusion, technological leadership, and cultural confidence.

Within this broader journey, the leadership of Narendra Modi has provided continuity and direction. The emphasis has been on long-term thinking—on building systems that endure and reforms that create lasting impact. It is this approach that has woven together the various strands of India's growth story.

The road ahead will inevitably bring new challenges. Global uncertainties, climate imperatives, and evolving economic dynamics will test the resilience of current gains. Yet, the trajectory of the past decade offers reason for optimism. It demonstrates that when governance is aligned with vision, and when policy is supported by participation, transformation is not only possible—it is sustainable.

India today stands at a moment of transition—not just from developing to developed, but from aspiration to assertion. The story of the past twelve years is not merely one of progress; it is one of possibility. And as the nation moves towards 2047, that possibility continues to take shape—quietly, steadily, and with a confidence that is increasingly unmistakable.

INDIA
TODAY STANDS
AT A MOMENT OF
TRANSITION—NOT JUST
FROM DEVELOPING TO
DEVELOPED, BUT FROM
ASPIRATION TO
ASSERTION

life. The emphasis has increasingly been on dignity, ensuring that progress is not abstract but tangible at the household level.

INNOVATION & GLOBAL ASPIRATION

India's transformation is also characterised by a surge in innovation and entrepreneurial energy. The country has emerged as the world's third-largest startup ecosystem, with thousands of new ventures driving solutions across sectors.

This growth is supported by a combination of policy support, digital infrastructure, and a large talent pool. From fintech and health-tech to clean energy and space

such as Jan Dhan has integrated millions into the formal financial system. Coupled with digital platforms, this has enabled direct benefit transfers, ensuring that subsidies and support reach beneficiaries with greater transparency and efficiency.

Healthcare has also been a priority, with initiatives aimed at expanding coverage and strengthening infrastructure. India's position as the "pharmacy of the world," supplying a significant share of global generic medicines and vaccines, further underscores its role in global health systems.

These efforts reflect a broader understanding of development—one that goes beyond income metrics to focus on quality of

significant. Countries across the world are studying India's digital model as a template for building scalable, inclusive financial systems. India is no longer merely adopting technology; it is shaping its global narrative.

INCLUSIVE GROWTH

Economic growth finds its true meaning in inclusion, and this has been a central focus of India's development strategy over the past decade. Welfare programmes aimed at housing, sanitation, healthcare, and financial inclusion have sought to bridge long-standing disparities.

Financial inclusion, in particular, has seen remarkable progress. The expansion of banking access through initiatives

What makes UPI particularly significant is its inclusivity. It has enabled seamless digital payments across socio-economic segments, from urban consumers to rural vendors. In fact, digital payments now account for nearly the entirety of transaction volumes in India, reflecting a near-complete shift towards digital financial systems.

This transformation is part of a broader digital ecosystem built around platforms such as Aadhaar, Jan Dhan accounts, and mobile connectivity—collectively known as India Stack. These systems have not only improved efficiency but have also reduced leakages in welfare delivery and expanded financial inclusion.

The global implications are



इंडिया इंफ्रास्ट्रक्चर फाइनेंस कंपनी लिमिटेड
(भारत सरकार का उद्यम)
India Infrastructure Finance Company Limited
(A Govt. of India Enterprise)



भविष्य की नींव का निधिकरण...
Funding Foundation of the Future...

Direct Lending

Subordinate Debt

Refinance

Takeout Finance

Credit Enhancement

Infrastructure Investment
Trusts (InvITs)

Infrastructure Project Bonds

India Infrastructure Finance Company Ltd. (IIFCL), established in 2006 as a wholly-owned Government of India (GoI) company has been playing an active role in providing long term financial assistance to commercially viable infrastructure projects in the country to sectors such as transport, energy, water & sanitation, communication, social and commercial Infrastructure, etc. with an overriding priority to Public Private Partnership (PPP) projects.

OUR SUBSIDIARIES

India Infrastructure Finance Company UK Limited
(A wholly owned subsidiary of IIFCL)
www.iifcl.org.uk

IIFCL Asset Management Company Limited
(A Wholly Owned Subsidiary of IIFCL, A Govt. of India Enterprise)
www.iifclmf.com

IIFCL Projects Limited
(A Govt. of India Undertaking)
www.iifclprojects.com

CORPORATE OFFICE

5th Floor, Block 2, Plate A & B, NBCC Tower, East Kidwai Nagar, New Delhi-110 023
Phone No : 91-11-24662777 | Fax: 91-11-23766256, 23730251 | CIN No : U67190DL2006G01144520

Email: information@iifcl.in | Website : www.iifcl.in
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ONGC

ENERGY: Now AND Next



Innovating Now
Shaping Next

NET
ZERO
by 2038

Scope-1 and Scope-2

We are ENERGY Now and Next

AMID ISRAEL-IRAN WAR

Israel Parl passes budget allowing Netanyahu to avoid early elections

TEL AVIV: Israel's parliament on Monday passed its annual budget in a marathon overnight session, ensuring that Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's government can complete its term until the fall.

Israel needed to pass a budget before April 1 in order to avoid triggering early elections. Netanyahu still reserves the right to call early elections before then if he wants.

Israel's opposition slammed the budget for increasing funding to Israel's ultra-Orthodox communities at a time when the country is facing soaring costs over its war in Iran and is still reeling from a two-year war in Gaza.

Opposition leader Yair Lapid called it "the greatest theft in the state's history."

"The government of glut-tony and evasion carried out a nocturnal heist," former Prime Minister Naftali Bennett, who is expected to challenge Netanyahu in upcoming elections, wrote on X.

Opposition parties were especially furious over a last-minute amendment providing an additional USD 250 million to ultra-Orthodox schools. Anger has increased at the ultra-Orthodox community for its refusal to allow its



Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu

young men to serve in the military while it is stretched to its breaking point and is in desperate need of additional soldiers. Military service is mandatory for most Jews.

Far-right Finance Minister Bezalel Smotrich praised the budget for "taking care of all Israeli citizens, without exception."

Netanyahu's government is in the final months of its four-year term and is required to hold elections by the end of October. Israeli governments rarely last their full

terms, though the budget's passage means Netanyahu, whose popularity has dropped since Hamas' October 7, 2023, attack, is now likely to complete his term. The budget passed 62-55. Sirens warning of missiles launched from Iran toward Jerusalem interrupted the discussions three times, according to the parliament's spokesperson. The session took place in the building's auditorium, rather than the plenum, because it is located closer to a bomb shelter.

The USD 270 billion

Highlights

- » Israel needed to pass a budget before Apr 1
- » Opposition leader Yair Lapid called it 'the greatest theft in the state's history'

**FINANCE MINISTER
PRAISED THE BUDGET
FOR 'TAKING CARE OF ALL
ISRAELI CITIZENS, WITHOUT
EXCEPTION'**

budget, Israel's largest ever, included a 20 per cent increase for the Ministry of Defense due to the ongoing war against Iran. The ministry's budget has swollen to USD 45 billion, forcing cuts in other government ministries.

Recent opinion polls in Israel indicate that while Israelis overwhelmingly support the war, Netanyahu and his political coalition don't appear to be benefiting.

Iran continues to fire missiles at Israel each day, disrupting the lives of millions of anxious and exhausted voters. Israel's war with Hezbollah militants in Lebanon also is intensifying, while the disruption of

the flow of oil from the Persian Gulf has upended the global economy.

Pushing off elections until the fall could allow Netanyahu to harness momentum from the Iran war once middle-of-the night sirens are a more distant memory for Israelis. But the election would also fall close to the anniversary of the October 7 attack, the worst in Israel's history.

Israel's military recently extended its wartime guidelines for civilians, which prevent large gatherings and encourage people to stay within a certain distance of bomb shelters, for an additional week. This means the wartime guidelines will include at least the first part of the weeklong Passover holiday, which starts on Wednesday.

Meanwhile, Netanyahu said Israel would expand what he called the "existing security strip" in Lebanon as Israeli forces continue to target the Iranian-backed Hezbollah militant group.

"We are determined to fundamentally change the situation in the north," he said on a visit to northern Israel, adding that "Hezbollah still has residual capability to fire rockets at us."

‘Pakistan to host US–Iran talks’

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan announced Sunday that it will soon host talks between the US and Iran, though there was no immediate word from Washington or Tehran, and it was unclear whether discussions on the month-long war would be direct or indirect.

"Pakistan is very happy that both Iran and the US have expressed their confidence in Pakistan to facilitate the talks. Pakistan will be honoured to host and facilitate meaningful talks between the two sides in the coming days," Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar said after top diplomats from Turkey, Egypt and Saudi Arabia met in Islamabad.

Pakistan later said the diplomats had departed for their home countries. The talks were originally scheduled to continue Monday.

Pakistan's foreign ministry did not answer questions, and Iran's mission to the United Nations declined to comment.

Islamabad has emerged as a mediator, having relatively good ties with Washington and Tehran, after what Pakistani officials call weeks of quiet diplomacy.

Earlier, Iran's parliament



speaker, Mohammad Bagher Qalibaf, dismissed the talks in Pakistan as a cover after some 2,500 US Marines trained in amphibious landings arrived in the Middle East.

He said Iranian forces were "waiting for the arrival of American troops on the ground to set them on fire and punish their regional partners forever," according to state media.

Iran also threatened to attack homes of US and Israeli "commanders and political officials" in the region. A spokesperson for the Iranian military's joint command, Ebrahim Zolfaghari, cited the "targeting of residential homes of the Iranian people in various cities" and other "malicious actions," state media reported.

"We don't know at what moment our homes could be targeted," said Razzak Saghir

al-Mousawi, 71, describing relentless airstrikes as Iranians crossing into Iraq urged the United States to end the war. "I am definitely afraid."

Meanwhile in Israel, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said the military will widen its invasion of Lebanon, expanding the "existing security strip" in that country's south while targeting the Iranian-backed Hezbollah militant group. No details were released.

Over 1 million Lebanese have been displaced in the war. One of them, Mohammad Doghman, called Israel "an expansionist state."

The war has threatened global supplies of oil, natural gas and fertilizer and disrupted air travel.

Iran's grip on the strategic Strait of Hormuz has shaken markets and prices.

Now the Iranian-backed Houthi rebels' entry into the war could threaten shipping on another crucial waterway, the Bab el-Mandeb strait to the Red Sea.

Israel's military said that its air force had intercepted two drones launched from Yemen very early on Monday morning.

AGENCIES

Gunmen kill at least 20 in attack in Nigeria

ABUJA: A night attack on a community in Nigeria's north-central region left at least 20 people dead, residents and authorities said. The attack occurred on Sunday night in Gari Ya Waye community in the Jos North area of Plateau state, Joyce Lohya Rampan, the state commissioner for information, said in a statement. She did not give the number of casualties, but said there was "loss of lives" and injuries.

The state government imposed a 48-hour curfew to prevent further attacks, Rampan said. No group has claimed responsibility.

Ibukun Falodun, a resident, said that 20 people were confirmed dead. Attacks in Plateau State are part of a long-running cycle of violence in north-central Nigeria, where disputes over land and grazing between mostly Muslim Fulani herders and largely Christian farming communities frequently escalate into deadly clashes. Criminal gangs are also active.

AGENCIES

Nepal's SC refuses interim relief to Oli

KATHMANDU: Nepal's Supreme Court on Monday refused to provide interim relief to former Prime Minister K P Sharma Oli, arrested over the 2025 Gen Z movement crackdown, even as protests continued in Nepal over his detention.

Oli and former home minister Ramesh Lekhak were arrested on Saturday for their alleged involvement in suppressing the Gen Z movement of September 8 and 9 last year, in which 76 people were killed.

In response to a habeas corpus petition filed by Oli's wife, Radhika Shakya, claiming her husband's detention is unlawful, a single bench of Justice Meghraj Pokharel refused to issue an interim order for Oli's release. The apex court instead asked the authorities to submit a written explanation clarifying the legal grounds for his detention.

The court gave a similar ruling to a habeas corpus petition filed on behalf of former home minister Ramesh Lekhak.

Monday's rally was comparatively peaceful, unlike the protests organised by the party on Saturday & Sunday

The arrests came after the newly formed Balendra Shah government decided to implement the report of the probe commission into the Gen Z protests in its first cabinet meeting.

Hundreds of members of Oli's Communist Party of Nepal (Unified Marxist-Leninist) and their sister organisations and student wings gathered at Naya Baneshwor area on Monday morning carrying placards that read "Immediately release KP Oli," and "End the politics of revenge." Monday's protest rally was comparatively peaceful, unlike the protests organised by the party on Saturday and Sunday.

AGENCIES

DESPITE BLOCKADE

No problem with Russian oil tanker bringing relief to Cuba: Prez Trump

ABOARD AIRFORCE ONE: US President Donald Trump on Sunday night said he has "no problem" with a Russian oil tanker off the coast of Cuba delivering relief to the island, which has been brought to its knees by a US oil blockade.

"We have a tanker out there. We don't mind having somebody get a boatload because they need... they have to survive," Trump told reporters as he flew back to



US President Donald Trump AP/PTI

Washington. When asked if a New York

Times report that the tanker would be allowed to reach Cuba was true, Trump said: "I told them, if a country wants to send some oil into Cuba right now, I have no problem whether it's Russia or not."

On Monday, Russia's Transport Ministry said the oil tanker Anatoly Kolodkin arrived at the Cuban port of Matanzas carrying "humanitarian supplies" of about 730,000 barrels of oil.

AGENCIES

US reopens embassy in Venezuela

WASHINGTON: The United States has formally reopened its embassy in Caracas, Venezuela, after the restoration of full diplomatic relations with the South American country following the Trump administration's ouster of then-President Nicolas Maduro in early January.

The State Department announced on Monday that it had resumed normal operations at the embassy in Caracas — which had been in need of significant repair, including remediation from mould — after a seven-year closure that began during President Donald Trump's first term. A small team of US diplomats, based in neighbouring Colombia, has been working in Caracas for more than a month, but the embassy itself has not yet been reopened.

AGENCIES

ADITYA BIRLA CAPITAL
LOANS INVESTMENTS INSURANCE PAYMENTS

ADITYA BIRLA CAPITAL LIMITED
Registered Office: Indian Rayon Compound, Veraval, Gujarat - 362266.
Corporate Office : 12th Floor, R Teck Park, Nirlon Complex, Near Hub Mall, Goregaon (East) Mumbai-400 063, MH.

E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE
15 days Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with provision to Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
On account of the amalgamation between Aditya Birla Finance Ltd. and Aditya Birla Capital Ltd. vide the Scheme of Amalgamation dated 11.03.2024 duly recorded in the Order passed by the National Company Law Tribunal - Ahmedabad on 24.03.2025, all SARFAESI actions initiated by Aditya Birla Finance Ltd. in relation to the mortgaged property mentioned, stands transferred to Aditya Birla Capital Ltd., the amalgamated company. Accordingly, the Authorized Officer of Aditya Birla Capital Limited / Secured Creditor had TAKEN POSSESSION of the following secured assets pursuant to notice issued under Sec. 13(2) of Securitisation & Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (SARFAESI) for recovery of the secured debts of the secured creditor, for the dues as mentioned herein below with further charges and cost thereon from the following Borrowers and Co-Borrowers. Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrowers and Co-Borrowers that e-auction of the following property for realization of the debts due to the Aditya Birla Capital Limited will be held on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" basis.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrowers & Co-Borrowers	Description of Properties / Secured Assets	Reserve Price (in Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (in Rs.) / Incremental Value (in Rs.)	Demand Notice Date & Total Amt. (in Rs.)
1.	1. Mr. Jasjeep Singh Bedi S/o. Amar Singh 2. Mr. Jasjeep Singh Bedi Proprietor, Mrs. Khalsa Traders 2. Mrs. Maninder Kaur C/o. Jasjeep Singh Bedi Lan: ABSAHS13000000714131 & ABSAHS13000000839920	All that piece and parcel of the Residential Area Bearing Municipal No. E/1720, Built On Plot Area 127.10 Sq. Mtrs. Measuring In East: 24ft., In West: 24 Ft., In North: 57 Ft., In South: 57 Ft., Situated In Mohalla Chatta, Nayi Colony, Ram Bagh Road, Kasba Gangoh, Pargana Gangoh, Tehsil Nakur, District: Saharanpur And Bounded As:- In East: House of Mr. Mam Chand, In West: Passage 10 Ft. Wide, In North: House of Mrs. Sunita Sharma, In South: Plot of Mr. Deepak Mittal.	Rs. 28,65,650/- (Rupees Twenty-Eight Lakh Sixty-Five Hundred Six Hundred And Fifty Only)	Rs. 2,86,565/- (Rupees Two Lakh Eighty-Six Thousand Five Hundred Sixty-Five Only) Rs. 25,000/- (Rs. Twenty Five Thousand Only)	06.06.2025 & Rs. 46,87,252/- (Rupees Forty Six Laks Sixty Seven Thousand Two Hundred Fifty Two Only) As On 05.06.2025

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in Aditya Birla Capital Limited / Secured Creditor's website i.e. <https://abli.adityabirlacapital.com/Pages/Individual-Properties-for-Auction-under-SARFAESI-Act.aspx> or <https://BidDeal.in> Contact Nos.: Aditya Birla Capital Limited, Authorized Officer Ashish Srivastava (9696515559), Parmeet Singh (9720029337), Apoorva Dantliwal (930909725), VedPrakash Mishra (90404026790), Mohit Sharma (9873913955), Komal Patil (9867895795), Jahirul Laskar (9706003075)
Place : Saharanpur, Uttar Pradesh Date : 31.03.2026
Sd/- Authorised Officer, Aditya Birla Capital Limited.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
Tender Notice
Invitation of tender through E-tendering (e-Procurement Systems)
NIT No. : 353935
Name of Work and its location : Tender for "Provision for refurbishment of Toilet and Non-AC area in LHB AC coaches." :
Approx. Cost of work : Rs. 1,92,76,020.96/- including GST (Rs. One Crore Ninety-Two Lakh Seventy-Six Thousand Twenty & paise Ninety-Six only).
Earnest Money : Rs. 2,46,400/-
Completion period of work : 12 months from date of LOA
Cost of Tender document on cash/by post : NIL
Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender : Upto 15:00 hrs. on 20.04.2026
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen : Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
No.: 353935 Dated: 30.03.2026 1059/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN-E-TENDER NOTICE
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

Name of work	Approx cost of work	Earnest Money	Cost of tender document
Upgradation of security infrastructure and allied works at DEMU shed at Shakurbasti in the section of SSE/W/DLI/Line under ADEN/DLI.	₹ 77,88,90,183.57/- (Rupees Seven Crore Eighty Eight Lakh Ninety Thousand One Hundred Eighty Three and Fifty Seven Paise Only)	₹ 15,77,80,000.00/- (Rupees Fifteen Lakh Seven Thousand Eight Hundred Only)	₹ 0.00/-

Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender : 22.04.2026 @15:00 Hrs.

Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen : www.ireps.gov.in

Allocation : 20426203

*The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. *For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. *No manual offers are acceptable. *Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.

No. No. 128-W/280/- Tender Notice/NIT/58-2025-26/W-3 Dated: 30.03.2026 1081/2026
SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN-E-TENDER NOTICE
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

Name of work	Approx cost of work	Earnest Money	Cost of tender document
Rag picking along track in the section of SSE/P.Way/NDLS under ADEN/NDLS.	Rs. 81,99,395.20/- (Rupees Eighty One Lakh Ninety Nine Thousand Three Hundred Ninety Five and Twenty Paise Only)	Rs. 1,64,000.00/- (Rupees One Lakh Sixty Four Thousand Only)	Rs. 0.00/-

Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender : 22.04.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen : www.ireps.gov.in

Allocation : 04-210-32

*The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. *For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. *No manual offers are acceptable. *Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only. No. 128-W/280/- Tender Notice/NIT/59/2025-26/W-3 Dated: 30.03.2026 1080/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN-E-TENDER NOTICE
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

Name of work	Approx cost of work	Earnest Money	Cost of tender document
Rag picking along track in the section of SSE/P.Way/NDLS under ADEN/NDLS.	Rs. 81,99,395.20/- (Rupees Eighty One Lakh Ninety Nine Thousand Three Hundred Ninety Five and Twenty Paise Only)	Rs. 1,64,000.00/- (Rupees One Lakh Sixty Four Thousand Only)	Rs. 0.00/-

Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender : 22.04.2026 at 15:00 Hrs.

Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen : www.ireps.gov.in

Allocation : 04-210-32

*The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. *For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. *No manual offers are acceptable. *Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only. No. 128-W/280/- Tender Notice/NIT/59/2025-26/W-3 Dated: 30.03.2026 1080/2026
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PUBLIC NOTICE
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohatk Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

The following borrower/s have defaulted on the repayment of principal and interest of the loan facilities obtained by them from ICICI Bank. The loans have been classified as Non-Performing Assets (NPA). A notice was issued to them under Section 13 (2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Securities Interest Act, 2002 (SARFAESI Act), at their last-known addresses. However, it was not served and hence they are being notified by way of this public notice.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number)	Description of Secured Asset to be Enforced.	Date of Notice Sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice	NPA Date
1.	Kamlesh Chadha/ Vivek Kumar Chadha/ Advanesh Kumar Mathur/ LBNOD0001420200/ B 326, Sector III, Rajender Nagar, Shahibabad, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh- 201010	Property At Flat No. E-129, Lajpat Nagar, Sector 4, Sohniabad, Ghaziabad- 201010	12-03-2026 Rs. 4,95,847/-	13-Sep-2024

These steps are being taken for a substituted service of notice. The mentioned Borrower/s and/or their Guarantor/s (as applicable) are advised to clear the payment of the outstanding dues within 60 days from the date of publication of this notice. Else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the SARFAESI Act.

Date : March 31, 2026, Place : Delhi/Ncr Authorised Officer, Secured Creditor

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused JK Gour, Director/Authorized Signatory M/S JK Gour Township Pvt. LTD. R/o 287, Gali No. 05, Durgapuri Extension, Shahdara, Delhi 110093 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case CC No.3500/2019, 4052/2019 & 5606/2019 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Bawana, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused JK Gour cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused JK Gour has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused JK Gour of CC No.3500/2019, 4052/2019 & 5606/2019 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Bawana, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 29.04.2026. By Order

Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05, (North District)
Court Room No.114, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi
DP/4130/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person Suraj Kushwaha @ Kalu, S/o Gaya Prasad, R/o Mavi Mohalla, Tehkhand Village, Okhla, Phase-1, New Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 153/2022, U/S 380/457/411/34 IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, South-East Distt., New Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Suraj Kushwaha @ Kalu cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Suraj Kushwaha @ Kalu has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant); Proclamation is hereby made that Suraj Kushwaha @ Kalu the said accused of FIR No. 153/2022, U/S 380/457/411/34 IPC, PS Okhla Industrial Area, South-East Distt., New Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 14.05.2026. By Order

Ms. Akansha Gautam
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
South-East Distt., Room No. 513,
Saket Courts Complex, New Delhi
DP/4003/SE/2026 (Court Matter)

BEFORE THE LD. SOLE ARBITRATOR MS. YANMI PHAZANG, (ADVOCATE) AT ACTUS LEGAL F8, LGF, GREEN PARK MAIN, NEW DELHI-110016

IN THE MATTER OF : M/S MONEYWISE FINANCIAL SERVICES PVT. LTD (Through its Authorised Representatives)CLAIMANT VERSUS HMS ELECTRONICS THROUGH ITS PROPRIETOR & ANR.RESPONDENTS
NOTICE OF HEARING
To,
1. MRS. USHA BIDNRA (CO-BORROWER)
W/o Mr. Dharam Pal Bindra
At: 31, 2nd Floor, Kalyan Vihar, Kamla Nagar, North Delhi, Delhi - 110007
Mob: 9891107933
E-Mail: binder88@gmail.com
Also At:
MRS. USHA BIDNRA
W/o Mr. Dharam Pal Bindra
At: Rana Pratap Bagh 31, 2nd floor, Kalyan Vihar, Kamal Nagar, South West Delhi, New Delhi- 110006
Mob: 9891107933
E-Mail: binder88@gmail.com
PLEASE TAKE NOTICE that the hearing in the above Arbitration case filed by the claimant Moneywise Financial Services Pvt. Ltd is fixed before the undersigned on 09.04.2026 at 03:30 P.M. through Virtualmode. The meeting link will be shared prior to the date of hearing. You are, therefore, directed to appear in the above noted case either personally or through your duly authorized representative on the date and time fixed through Physical mode. PLEASE NOTE that in case you fail to appear and attend the matter on the date and time given above, the matter will be proceeded with in your absence and shall be decided in accordance with law
sd/-
Place: New Delhi MS. YANMI PHAZANG
Date : 27.03.2026 (Sole Arbitrator)

केनरा बैंक Canara Bank
SPECIALIZED SME NANGLOI (NANGLOI) BRANCH DP CODE - 19015
Canara Bank PIGMY/NND Agents Mr. Babu Ram Chandel, Mr. Indrajit Budhiraja and Mr. Anoop Kumar Budhiraja have resigned from Canara Bank dated 25/02/2026. If any customer has any claim, kindly bring to bank notice within 30 days from the public notice and no claims will be entertained after the expiry of stipulated period.
CHIEF MANAGER, SPECIALIZED SME NANGLOI (NANGLOI) BRANCH DP CODE - 19015

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Joshim Khan S/o Abdul Kalam R/o A-215, Ram Nagar, Nabi Karim, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.124/2019, u/s 457/380/411 IPC, P.S. Prasad Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused Joshim Khan cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Joshim Khan has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Joshim Khan of FIR No.124/2019, u/s 457/380/411 IPC, P.S. Prasad Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 06.06.2026. By Order

Sh. Karanbir Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-02
Central District, Room No. 26
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi
DP/4063/CD/2026

The Royal son

Roaring start for Rajasthan as Sooryavanshi stars

GUWAHATI: Indian batting sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi smashed a 15-ball half-century after an impressive show from the bowlers, setting up an emphatic eight-wicket win for Rajasthan Royals in their IPL opener against a sluggish Chennai Super Kings here on Monday.

Royals made good use of the overhead conditions to bowl out Chennai Super Kings for 127.

It was a forgettable batting performance for CSK, who were put in to bat by Riyan Parag on a pitch that had been under cover for a while due to rain.

The 15-year-old Sooryavanshi has made massive strides in his career since his record hundred in the IPL last season. His rare talent was on full display against a hapless CSK attack.

With Sooryavanshi going ballistic from his end, his opening partner Yashasvi Jaiswal was happy to give the strike back to the fellow left-hander. Royals raced to victory in 12.1 overs. The result was a foregone conclusion after Sooryavanshi enjoyed an 18-run over. He was dropped by Kartik Sharma in that same over and duly made CSK pay heavily for that error.

Some of his awe inducing strokes included a six over point off a slower ball from New Zealand pacer Matt Henry. Sooryavanshi became



Rajasthan Royals' Vaibhav Sooryavanshi celebrates his half century PTI

the third fastest to an IPL fifty with a couple of sixes off spinner Noor Ahmad.

Following his fall, Jaiswal (38 not out off 36) and Riyan Parag (14 not out off 11) completed the formalities for Royals with plenty to spare.

While the home team ticked all boxes, CSK looked completely out of sorts in their opener and will need to go back to the drawing board.

Both CSK and the Royals, the two bottom placed teams last season, had traded their star players Ravindra Jadeja and Sanju Samson ahead of the season. It was a successful

return to the Royals for Jadeja, who struck twice in his opening over.

Samson, star of India's T20 World Cup triumph, could not fire on his CSK debut. In an attempt to dispatch Nandre Burger over mid-wicket, he saw his off-stump getting dislodged with a sharp delivery that seamed away. Both Nandre and Jofra Archer got the ball to talk in the powerplay.

After Nandre got rid of Samson, Archer sent back CSK skipper Rituraj Gaikwad who backed away to go for an aerial stroke on the off-side only to see his stumps rattled.

'Don't want unwated stories'

MUMBAI: India's T20 skipper Suryakumar Yadav playing as an impact substitute in the Mumbai Indians' IPL opener here was a precautionary measure due to a niggle he is nursing, said head coach Mahela Jayawardene, insisting that there are no "unwanted stories" to be found in this.

Suryakumar did not field for MI in their first match of the season against Kolkata Knight Riders and scored an 8-ball 16 during a brief stay in the middle as the hosts hammered KKR by 6 wickets to record their highest successful run chase in IPL history here on Sunday.

"I hope we don't create unwanted stories (here), the camp is happy. He had an extra couple of days (off that) he wanted," Jayawardene told reporters. "So please don't create any stories. It's just that I have to take precautions. These are very valuable players for me to have them going throughout the season."

Sheetal Devi named 'Para Archer of the Year'

LAUSANNE: India's Sheetal Devi has been named 'Para Archer of the Year 2025' by World Archery, adding to her extraordinary achievements, which also include a historic world championship crown.

The 19-year-old from Jammu & Kashmir became the first and only female armless archer to win gold at the World Para Archery Championships by claiming the top honours in the women's compound individual event in Gwangju, South Korea last year.

Born without arms, Sheetal skilfully uses her feet, legs, and shoulder to draw the bow and shoot. She also secured a complete set of medals at the World Championships, winning the women's team silver and mixed team bronze. "Sheetal Devi took the honour in the para archer of the year category after another breakthrough season that included a world title in Gwangju," said World Archery.

Beyond her World Championship gold, Sheetal also boasts of a Paris Paralympics bronze in the mixed team event, along with individual silver from the 2022 Asian Para Games.

Pragg draws with Wei Yi, stays in lead

PAPHOS: Indian Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa played out an easy draw as black against Wei Yi of China and stayed in joint lead on 1.5 points after the second round of the FIDE Candidates tournament here on Monday.

After a brilliant first round win over Anish Giri, Praggnanadhaa appeared to be in fine fettle for the second day running, putting a bit of pressure on his Chinese counterpart out of a French defense game with black pieces.

Wei Yi decided against going for a complicated struggle and the pieces changed hands at regular intervals leading to a drawn opposite coloured Bishops endgame.

Praggnanadhaa had an extra pawn to boast but white's position was simply impregnable. The peace was signed in 46 moves. While the opening round provided a lot of fireworks with as many as three decisive games out of a possible four, things calmed down in the second game. Anish Giri played solidly with his white pieces to draw with Fabiano Caruana of United States and Uzbek star Javokhir Sldarov was held to a draw.

Asian Cup: All eyes on Williams as India play for pride vs Hong Kong

KOCHI: All eyes will be on Australian-born winger Ryan Williams as India face Hong Kong in the final match of what has been a failed campaign in the AFC Asian Cup 2027 Qualifiers, here on Tuesday.

While the campaign has been one to forget for the Blue Tigers, the much-anticipated debut of the new No. 11 marks a significant new chapter for the national team.

Out of contention for the 2027 tournament, both India and Hong Kong will also look to gain FIFA ranking points and build for their future assignments when the two sides lock horns at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium.

The match will also mark the return of international football to the city after a decade, a much-needed event for a state that is considered one of the biggest hubs of Indian football with the locals always eager to turn up in large numbers for football matches at any level.

With a strong performance on the field against Hong Kong, the Indian team will hope to end the campaign on a positive note, barely days after its head coach Khalid Jamil and some of the players were denied entry at the venue due to non-payment of a mandatory security deposit



Ryan Williams addition is a significant moment for Indian football AIFF

Hong Kong, coached by Ashley Westwood, have lost once in their last 12 matches

to the stadium owners by the Kerala Football Association.

While the payment issue had been resolved after the All India Football Federation (AIFF) intervened, it remains to be seen how the home team performs in its last match of the qualifying tournament.

Another India player who could influence the outcome of the match on Tuesday is Lalengmawia Ralte, commonly known by his nickname Apuia.

In the absence of Punjab FC midfielder Nikhil Prabhu due to an injury, Apuia has stepped up and established himself in the midfield. He has displayed good form for Mohun Bagan this season, playing as a lone striker under Sergio Lobera.

Apuia will be keen to replicate his club form in the national team jersey. Jamil had named a 23-member squad for the match, including established names such as Sahal Abdul Samad and Ashique Kuruniyan. Hong Kong, coached by former Bengaluru FC manager Ashley Westwood, have only lost once in their last 12 matches and will be looking to repeat their 1-0 victory over India in the qualifiers.



New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-6, Noida-201304 (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE
E-Tenders are invited from eligible contractors/firm for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on Noida Authority's official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

A) Fresh-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
1.	08/SM(WC-8)/ET/2025-26	M/o Village (Renovation of Pond in Village Salarpu) Noida	27.58
2.	53/GM/SM(WC-10)/ET/2025-26	Emergency of work (M/o Vilopit Kudaghar cleaning of debrisand dressing of surface nearby Vilopit Kudaghar in WC-10 area), Noida	8.29
3.	53/GM/SM(WC-9)/ET/2025-26	M/o Road (P/F Indicator Board in Sector-163, 164, 165, 166 and 168) Noida.	27.45
4.	18/DGM/SM(WC-9)/ET/2025-26	D/o Village (C/o Girls Toilet in Primary School and C/o Kitchen in Junior High School in Village Wazidpur) Noida	11.69
5.	65/GM/SM(WC-6)/PH/2025-2026	Catching work of Unruly Monkeys and releasing them in protected forest areas in various sectors and Villages in WC-6 to 10 area, Noida	29.00

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 01.04.2026 to 15.04.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 16.04.2026 at 11.00 AM.

B) Re-Tender Work:

S. No.	Jobs No.	Name of the work	Tender Amount (Rs. Lacs)
6.	25/GM/SM(WC-6)/2025-2026	M/o Road (Widening of MP-3 road near Hindon Pusta), Noida.	24.44
7.	26/GM/SM(WC-6)/2025-2026	M/o Road (Widening of Main Carriage way of FNG road near Indian National School), Noida.	18.03
8.	07/DGM/SM(WC-9)/ET/2025-2026	D/o Village (C/o Kitchen in Primary School of Village Chapprol for Operation of Kayakalp) Noida	5.85
9.	05/SM(WC-8)/ET/2025-26	M/o Road (R/o cut patch and sealing of crack at 45.00 mtr. wide road between Sector-82 & 93 and 92 & 93), Noida.	29.47
10.	28/GM/SM(WC-6)/2025-2026	Development Sector-116 (C/o Kitchen and other Maintenance work in Community Centre Sector-116), Noida	9.14

The above tenders can be uploaded from dated 01.04.2026 to 07.04.2026 up to 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on dated 08.04.2026 at 11.00 AM.

General Manager (Civil)
NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

NORTHERN RAILWAY
OPEN E-TENDER NOTICE
The Sr. Divisional Engineer-III, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites E-Tender for the following work.

Name of work	Renovation & Conversion of 09 Rooms into Officer's Rest House and Subordinate Rest House at 2nd Floor (Right Wing) of Station Building Anand Vihar, Improvement of connecting of connecting approach road for Saloon Siding from Circulating Area and improvement of approach road from Coach Care Center up to Washing Line Complex, along with repairs to leaky roof of Coach Care Center and Lathe Machine Shed, including replacement of damaged valley gutters and ridge and Repair and replacement of old. corroded and damaged sheets and valley gutters of Platform sheds 01 to 07, including allied works for improvement of passenger amenities at Anand Vihar Railway Terminal at ANVT in the S/O SSE/W/ANVT under ADEN/NDLS.
Approx cost of work	₹ 4,19,55,591.98/- (Rupees Four Crore Nineteen Lakh Fifty Five Thousand Five Hundred Ninety One and Ninety Eight Paise Only)
Earnest Money to deposited	₹3,59,800.00/- (Rupees Three Lakh Fifty Nine Thousand Eight Hundred Only)
Cost of tender document	₹0.00/-
Date & Time of submission of tender bid and opening of tender	20.04.2026 @15:00 Hrs.
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in
Allocation	04-410-32

*The tenderer/s must be registered on the Indian Railway E-Procurement system (IREPS) site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for participating in the e-tender system. *For all terms and conditions please refer tender document. *No manual offers are acceptable. *Cost of tender document and Earnest money will be acceptable through net banking or payment gateway only.

No. No. 128-W/280/e Tender Notice/NIT/54/2025-26/W-3 Dated: 27.03.2026

SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 1058/2026

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the constructive possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 20.04.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M. for recovery of Rs. 12,36,288/- (Rupees Twelve Lakh Thirty Six Thousand Two Hundred Eighty Eight only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLDPC00492643, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 23.03.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 24.03.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from SHUBHAM PATHAK and RAMAKANT DUBEY.

The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 7,30,000/- (Rupees Seven Lakh Thirty Thousand only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 73,000/- (Rupees Seventy Three Thousand only) i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
FLAT NO. F. F. - 207 (L. I. G.), HAVING COVERED AREA 325 SQUARE FEET EQUIVALENT TO 30.19 SQUARE METERS, ON 1ST FLOOR (MID-LEVEL SIDE, (WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS) CONSTRUCTED UPON PLOT NO. B - 7A/11, DLF, ANKUR VIHAR, SITUATED IN VILLAGE SADULLABAD, TEHSIL LONI, DISTRICT GHAZIABAD - 201022, UTTAR PRADESH AND WHICH IS BOUNDED AS FOLLOWS:-
EAST : FLAT NO. F. F. 206, NORTH : FLAT NO. F. F. 205,
WEST : 9 MTRS. WIDER ROAD, SOUTH : FLAT NO. F. F. 201.

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Date : 23.03.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

AUTHORISED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as
INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr. PC. /84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Mohan Kumar, S/o Sh. Roop Kumar R/o H.No. 1318, Pana Paposia, Narela, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in case CT No.3593/2018 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Alipur, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Mohan Kumar cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Mohan Kumar has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Mohan Kumar of CT No.3593/2018 u/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Alipur, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 23.05.2026.

By Order
Ms. Priyanka Rajpoot
Chief Judicial Magistrate, North
Court No. 115, First Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/4078/ON/2026

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 20.04.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M. for recovery of Rs. 31,88,007/- (Rupees Thirty One Lakh Eighty Eight Thousand Seven only) pending towards Loan Account No. HLHRN0391811, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 23.03.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 24.03.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from SANJAY KUMAR and NEETU.

The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 10,10,000/- (Rupees Ten Lakh Ten Thousand only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 1,01,000/- (Rupees One Lakh One Thousand only) i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
RESIDENTIAL FLAT NUMBER GF - 3, M. I. G., (GROUND FLOOR), HAVING A COVERED AREA OF 700 SQUARE FEET I. E. 65.03 SQUARE METERS, SITUATED AT PLOT NUMBER A - 47, BLOCK - A, COMPRISING OF KHASRA NUMBER 1278, IN "S. F. F. VED VIHAR", HADBAST VILLAGE LONI, DISTRICT GHAZIABAD - 201102, UTTAR PRADESH.

EAST : PLOT NO. A-58 NORTH : FLAT NO. GF - 4 (M. I. G.)
WEST : COMMON PASSAGE SOUTH : PLOT NO. A-46

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Date : 23.03.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

AUTHORIZED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as
INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82 Cr.PC)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Mahavir, S/o Nanak Ram R/o Sec-7, Near Flyover, RK Puram, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.478/2019 u/s 454/380/411/34 IPC, P.S. Hari Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Mahavir cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Mahavir has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Mahavir of FIR No.478/2019 u/s 454/380/411/34 IPC, P.S. Hari Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 04.05.2026.

By Order,
Moksha Bain-I
Judicial Magistrate First Class-II, West Court No.31
Tis Hazari Courts, New Delhi

DP/4072/WD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Akash @ Gajni, S/o Moni Kumar R/o Jhuggi No.20, 2nd Floor, C-Block, Naraina, Opposite-Kapoor Hospital, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No.175/2016 u/s 380/457/411 IPC, P.S. Kashmir Gate, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Akash @ Gajni cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Akash @ Gajni has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused Akash @ Gajni of FIR No.175/2016 u/s 380/457/411 IPC, P.S. Kashmir Gate, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 08.05.2026.

By Order,
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11 (Central)
Room No.138, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/4049/N/2026

APPENDIX IV-A
Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property
E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and Rule 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Capital Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Housing Finance Ltd.) [CIN : L65922DL2005PLC136029] ("Secured Creditor"), the physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 20.04.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 28,93,991/- (Rupees Twenty Eight Lakh Ninety Three Thousand Nine Hundred Ninety One only) pending towards Loan Account No. HHLNOD00497983, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 23.03.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 24.03.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from LATA (CO - BORROWER, WIFE AS WELL AS LEGAL HEIR OF LATE DHARAM VEER), VIKAS (MINOR SON AS WELL AS LEGAL HEIR OF LATE DHARAM VEER THROUGH NATURAL GUARDIAN), VANSH (MINOR SON AS WELL AS LEGAL HEIR OF LATE DHARAM VEER THROUGH NATURAL GUARDIAN), RINKI (MINOR DAUGHTER AS WELL AS LEGAL HEIR OF LATE DHARAM VEER THROUGH NATURAL GUARDIAN) and DEV (MINOR SON AS WELL AS LEGAL HEIR OF LATE DHARAM VEER THROUGH NATURAL GUARDIAN).

The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 16,00,000/- (Rupees Sixteen Lakh only) and the Earnest Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 1,60,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Sixty Thousand only) i. e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
FLAT NO. G - 2 (M. I. G.), HAVING SUPER COVERED AREA 600 SQUARE FEET EQUIVALENT TO 55.74 SQUARE METERS, ON GROUND FLOOR, BACK SIDE (WITHOUT ROOF RIGHTS), SITUATED AT PLOT NO. A - 29, DLF DILSHAD EXT - II, VILLAGE BRAHMAMPUR ALIAS BHOPURA, GHAZIABAD - 201005, UTTAR PRADESH AND WHICH IS BOUNDED AS FOLLOWS :-
EAST : PLOT NO. A-30 WEST : PLOT NO. A-28
NORTH : ROAD 30 FEET WIDE SOUTH : PLOT NO. A-34

For detailed terms and conditions of sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaancapital.com; Contact No : 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024; E-mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

Date : 23.03.2026
Place : GHAZIABAD

AUTHORISED OFFICER
SAMMAAN CAPITAL LIMITED (Formerly known as
INDIABULLS HOUSING FINANCE LTD.)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Arif S/o Mohd. Ahmed R/o C-5/9, Chouhan Banger, Letter Box wali Gali No.6, Jafraabad, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 29/05 u/s 457/380/411 IPC at P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Arif cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Arif has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said Arif accused of FIR No. 29/05 u/s 457/380/411 IPC at P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on 23.05.2026.

By Order: Shri Pankaj Rai,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
Room No. 73, Fifth Floor, North-East Distt.,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

DP/3616/NE/2026



Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, Landmark, Race Course Circle, Vadodara - 390007
Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400051
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited shat Tower Plot No-23, New Rohtak Road Karol Bagh New Delhi - 110005

Notice for Disclosure of Legal Heirs of Deceased Borrower
PUBLIC NOTICE
Notice is hereby given that Home Loan LBFD000006305058 / LBFD000005489966 / LBFD000006383069 (Credit facility) was granted to RAJNI PARMAR OF BORROWER, Co-Borrower, Guarantor/Mortgagor (excluding deceased borrower) (Borrowers) along with the deceased VIPIN KUMAR SINGH by ICICI Bank Ltd. (The Bank).
We would like to inform you that the demise of VIPIN KUMAR SINGH has come to our knowledge during field visits conducted by the Bank officials and by telephonic communications with the registered contact numbers. In this regard, letter dated 26 March 26, 2026, was previously sent to the registered addresses of the Borrowers and the deceased VIPIN KUMAR SINGH, for providing information about the Legal Heirs of the deceased Borrower.
Therefore, this Notice is hereby given for sharing details of the Legal Heirs of the deceased VIPIN KUMAR SINGH with supporting documents for updating the Bank's records, within 15 days of publication of this Notice.
You may submit the above-mentioned details to SHIVOM SINGH by visiting Address: ICICI BANK LTD PLOT NO. 7, COMMUNITY CENTRE S.D. TOWER, SECTOR 8, ROHINI NEW DELHI-110085.
Date : March 31, 2026
Place : Faridabad (Haryana) <SD> Authorised Officer For ICICI Bank Ltd.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
(See Section 82(2)(i) Cr.P.C.)
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely Rahul S/o Ravi, R/o: B-5A, 1st Floor, Sitapuri Extn. Part-1, Dabri, Delhi (or is suspected to has committed) the offence in FIR No. 92/2018, U/s 356/379/34 IPC, Date: 10.02.2018, registered at P.S.: Rajouri Garden, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused Rahul cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Rahul has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said Rahul accused FIR No. 92/2018, U/s 356/379/34 IPC, registered at P.S.: Rajouri Garden, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before 07.05.2026.

By Order
Sh. Shashank Nandan Bhatt
Metropolitan Magistrate(West)
Court No. 356, 3rd Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/3928/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

The Bollywood actress called her character from the film the 'hottest' she has done so far

KRITI SANON ON HER 'COCKTAIL 2' CHARACTER

'I'M LOOKING VERY DIFFERENT'

Kriti Sanon is gearing up for the release of her next film, 'Cocktail 2', co-starring Shahid Kapoor and Rashmika Mandanna. The actress recently shared that her character in the upcoming film is the 'hottest' role of her career. She credited director Homi Adajania for this new on-screen avatar of her in the movie.

In an interview with 'Bollywood Hungama', Kriti Sanon shared that her avatar in 'Cocktail 2' will be 'very different'. She further stated that Homi Adajania brought out the 'cool' side of her personality, which she had no idea about. "I think I'm looking very different from what I've ever looked and it's probably the hottest character that I've done so far. Homi is someone who has a great, great aesthetic visual sense and he's just inherently cool. He has brought a cool side to me that I didn't know I had," she said.

In the same conversation, the actress clarified that the storylines of 'Cocktail 2' and 'Cocktail' are not interlinked. However, she added that the second instalment has the same vibe as the previous one. "It carries a vibe similar to 'Cocktail', which is also present in 'Cocktail 2'," she said.

Directed by Homi Adajania, the film also stars Shahid Kapoor and Rashmika Mandanna

She further shared, "The story involves two girls and one boy. The tone and atmosphere are in a comparable realm, yet the narrative and characters are entirely distinct."

The actress stated that the upcoming film has a mix of 'emotions, camaraderie, drama, music and stunning locations', just like the previous instalment.

Directed by Homi Adajania, 'Cocktail 2' is slated to hit theatres on June 19, 2026. AGENCIES

Sayani Gupta turns producer & director with 'Aasmani'



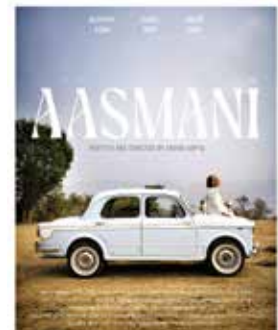
OUR CORRESPONDENT

Margarita with a Straw' actor Sayani Gupta is stepping into a new phase as she launches her production house, 'Sayani Gupta Movies' (SGM). Leading the slate is her directorial debut short film 'Aasmani', which becomes the first project under the banner.

After spending over a decade working across films and streaming, the 'Four More Shots Please' actor said the shift towards production comes from a growing need to be more involved in storytelling from the ground up.

"It has been a long dream. I've been wanting to tell certain kinds of stories and the idea is to be able to create an enabling space for collaboration. We will go slowly but steadily, concentrating on one film at a time. For us, the quality of writing, craft, storytelling will always take precedence and for that to happen, the right kind of time, care and attention needs to be given to every project," said the 'Jab Harry Met Sejal' actor.

Starring Revathy along with Daria Bedi and Abhay Kaul, 'Aasmani' has been written, directed and produced by Sayani. At the same time, she



'It has been a long dream. I've been wanting to tell certain kinds of stories,' she says

has earlier co-produced projects like 'Where the Winds Blow' and 'Upar Neeche' and various short films like 'Dear Men' and Oscar-qualifying 'Shameless'. 'Aasmani' is her first full-blown production.

Sayani spent over a year scouting locations across the state of Maharashtra. Pune eventually became their base, given her connection to her alma mater, FTII. The film also brings together executive producers Nikkhil Advani, Dia Mirza and Ananya Rane.

नमो अरिहंताणं, नमो सिद्धाणं
भगवान
महावीर
जयंती

की समस्त देशवासियों को
हार्दिक शुभकामनाएं

शांति, संयम और सद्भावना से जुड़े भगवान महावीर के संदेश विकसित भारत के निर्माण में देश के लिए प्रेरणापुंज हैं।
- नरेन्द्र मोदी, प्रधानमंत्री

सत्यमेव जयते
दिल्ली सरकार

DIP/Shabdarth/Display/01 62/25-26